

Gilbert Doble's

"Winged Victory"

War Memorial, Wellington, N.S.W.

by

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Thesis submitted to the Faculty of Humanities, Deakin University, Geelong Campus, in partial fulfilment of the requirements of the Degree of Bachelor of Arts with Honours.

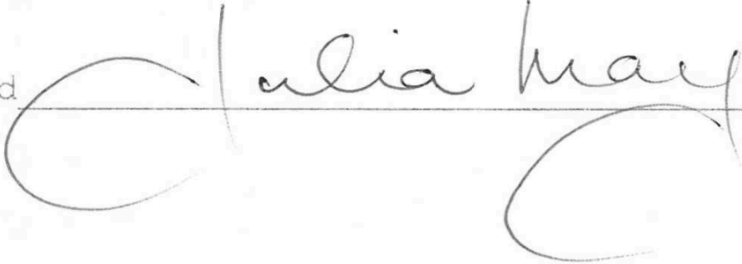
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ADDENDUM

The artist's date on the statue (on a hem of the central figure's garments) is 1928.

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Frontispiece Wellington War Memorial (1923-33)
Gilbert Doble

Frontispiece Wellington War Memorial (1923-33)
Gilbert Doble

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PREFACE

In pursuing the research for this thesis, I have been fortunate both in the circumstances in which I have been able to work, and in the response, I have had from the people whom I have approached. Individuals, institutions and organisations have been most helpful – what has impressed me most is that for them it is perfectly normal. Just being prepared to listen, and to share their ideas about my topic was most valuable.

I cannot visualise being able to have continued the studies I have without the unstinting support I have had from my family, in particular my mother, June Sutherland. With both logistic and moral support, she has made it possible for me to continue in good heart. Friends, too, have been encouraging, if bemused at my choice of topic.

Particular thanks must go to Stanley Douglas of the Wellington Sub-Branch of the RSL. He is tremendously keen, and was happy to help me in even the smallest way. The Wellington Historical Society was also helpful, placing their resources at my disposal as much as they could.

In different ways, other people helped me most generously: Bill Clements, Michael McKernan, Ken Inglis, Chris Mullins, Murdoch McLeod, Robin Wallace-Crabbe, Patrick Hutchings, Richard Read, Rob McLachlan, Vanessa Hoheb, Bruce Sutherland, Chris and Therese May, Victor Cusack, Chris Meader, Anne Carolan and Vera Hatton. Even the slightest interest shown was helpful; Norma Hutchings and Claire Baker, Chris Helyar, Ann Gray, Wendy Wilson and Irene Sutherland.

The libraries of Deakin University, Australian National University, the National Gallery of Australia and of Charles Sturt University – Riverina were invaluable in their resources for me. Of course, most thanks must go to Deakin Library for their unstinting help in finding material. The Australian War Memorial archives, too, were very helpful.

The Bathurst Historical Society and the Riverina Archives were most efficient and helpful as well. The facilities at The Riverina Leader were most generously made available to me.

While Mrs Hatton and Ms Carolan were accessible to my requests, they limited their responses because of a declared interest in publishing a commentary on their collections of Gilbert Doble's material. I acknowledge absolutely that they are within their rights to place such a restriction on access, but it did mean that I was not able to make a fully informed comment on Doble's work away from his monuments.

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This is an investigation of an obscure sculpture by an unknown artist in a small country town.

Enquiry revealed that Gilbert Doble, who designed and made the War Memorial in Wellington, New South Wales, had several monuments in the public domain. It also revealed that he had used his skills as a stonemason and trophy maker to erect monuments in Bathurst, Sydney and Wellington, all in New South Wales.

Doble made decorative, electroformed plaques to be attached to furniture, as well as trophies and medals. He established a public with his Bathurst monuments, and the photographs which he took himself served as a folio of work for the future. In comparison to bronze casting, electroforming was inexpensive. Doble was proficient in it, and had set up a workroom and studio in Way Street, Marrickville, NSW.

At the end of the First World War, Doble was able to capitalise on the existence of several factors: he knew his own area of Marrickville and adjacent suburbs, and was known himself; the areas were poor; and his technique was affordable. As well, a large proportion of their population had volunteered to enlist, and a significant number had become casualties. The commitment and need in the communities for a significant monument was strong. He made monuments for Marrickville, Pyrmont and Leichhardt, thus establishing further his reputation for making important looking monuments well, and at an affordable price.

In 1920, the Wellington War Memorial Committee held a competition for a design for their monument. Doble won the competition, and received £100. Though the area was not poor, a large proportion of the male population had enlisted, and the commitment to a significant memorial was as strong as in the inner city. Doble's quote was for £3000, for which he would lay out a garden setting, install a fence and gate and erect a three figure group on a plinth. With the economical electro-forming process, and his expertise as a stonemason, he was able to promise excellent work for the price.

Constant in Doble's work, both in the applied arts (the plaques) and in the sculpture, was the lack of Christian imagery. He had often used classical references, even if mediated through the French mode of the time. In keeping with the classical slant of his work was the frequent use of the female figure, unusual in the imagery of World War One memorials in Australia.

Analysis of the elements that make up the Wellington War Memorial, Wellington, NSW suggests that a complex iconography lay behind it. The placement of the garden, the construction of the monument and the choice of imagery all point to a considered programme of commemoration based on the 18th century 'Field of Rest', or funerary garden. A conjunction of classical motifs, the social setting and the popularity of Norman Lindsay's ideas among Australian artists and writers suggest the presence of an impulse to give expression to the Australian view of Nietzsche's writings at the time.

Taken in the context of Doble's other public works, the Wellington War Memorial is a significant success. Unusual in Australia in its use of female figures, the group achieves an individual expression that has called on past influences, in particular the classical.

GILBERT DOBLE AND HIS WORK

Gilbert Doble (1880–1974) was born in England (Illus.1). His family migrated to Australia while he was still a small child. He left School at an early age, and since his trade was as a stonemason, he must at some stage been trained by one. As a stonemason, his work would have included funerary monuments and ornaments for buildings in Sydney. He was well-known for his decorative metal-work, making portrait medallions, trophies, plaques and shields. Examples of his work were the large silver shield presented to the British battleship 'Commonwealth' by the people of Australia in 1909, and the shield presented to Harry Houdini by the Aerial League of Australia in 1910.¹

His modelling studio was in Unwin's Bridge Road, Marrickville, with a workshop for electro-forming in Way Street, Tempe.²

At the time Doble was working in Marrickville and Tempe from 1912 and on past the First World War, art influences in Australia were essentially conservative. Neo-Classicism and Realism, with Art Nouveau in the applied arts continued over from the 19th century.

In painting, the Heidelberg painters still were influential, and graphic artist such as Norman Lindsay and George Lambert reflected their society humorously in a fluent but straightforward style. Sculptors such as Bertram McKennal and Charles Richardson in Victoria made classical references, but modelled their work in a naturalistic style. For example, Richardson's The Discovery of Gold (1906) shows the allegorical figure of Victoria standing over a miner depicted panning for gold (Illus.2), and McKennal made Tragedy Enveloping Comedy (1906)³. McKennal's Circe (1893) also is naturalistic with a classical

¹ Anne Carolan, *'The Winged Victory's Two Sculptors'*, Heritage – Journal of Marrickville Heritage Society, Vol. 5 (1989), p.43.

² Carolan, loc.cit. For process, see Appendix 3.

³ Ballarat Fine Art Gallery, Victoria.

subject, with elements that mark it as Art Nouveau in style, for example, the treatment of the hair, the Symbolist tenor of the depiction and sinuous design on the base.⁴

One of the sources of new ideas was the presence in Australia from 1913 of Walter Burley Griffin and Marion Mahony. Their designs for Newman College (1917–1918)⁵ both in architecture and in furniture and fittings followed the precepts of the Art and Craft Movement in America, where function and materials guided design. They transmitted values brought from Frank Lloyd Wright's architecture office where Mahoney worked for ten years.⁶

Art Nouveau with its flowing and sinuous designs based on nature is evident in craft objects in Australia such as Fireplace Surround (1910) Robert Prenzler.⁷

New art movements of the late 19th and early 20th century such as Post-Impressionism, Fauvism, Non-Objective painting and Cubism were slow to penetrate to the mainstream of Australian society. Up until the time of the Exhibition of French and British Modern Art in 1939, they were only available as a reference to Australian-based artist in the form of inadequate reproductions.⁸

The tide of nationalism in Australia continued from the time of its concerted rise in the 1880's to well after Federation. Art was admired if it reflected reality, especially the new nation, or if it reflected high moral values. A departure from this was the hedonistic work of Norman Lindsay, which showed a raffish *joie-de-vivre*, loosely based on works such as those by for example Fragonard.

⁴ National Gallery of Victoria.

⁵ J.M. Freeland, *Architecture in Australia*, F.W. Cheshire, Sydney.

⁶ Ursula de Jong, *Art and Architecture of the 20th Century – Australia and the West: Reader and Study Guide*, Deakin University Press, 1992.

⁷ John McPhee, *Australian Decorative Arts*, Australian National Gallery, Canberra, 1982, pp.40–41.

⁸ Bernard Smith with Terry Smith, *Australian Painting 1788–1990*, Oxford University Press, Melbourne, 1991, p.206.

In the first years of the 20th century in Australia, art influences of the 19th century were continuing – the Academic style, Impressionism, John Ruskin's return to what he was were essentials with the Pre-Raphaelite Brotherhood, William Morris' Art and Craft Movement. For example, I.B. Hall's Sleep (c.1918), E. Phillips Fox's The Arbour (c.1910), Rupert Bunny's Endormie (c.1904), and in the applied arts Robert Prenzel's Large Wardrobe from the Mathias Suite (1906).⁹

In Europe in the period 1890 to 1914 sculptors such as Rodin, Maillol, Minne, Lehmbruck and Barlach showed tendencies which could be associated with Post-Impressionism.¹⁰ There is little except perhaps Merric Boyd's ceramics such as Vase (1916)¹¹ in Australia to show similar tendencies in the years before the First World War.

In his trophies, medals and plaster plaques, Doble made a name with his scenes based on classical myths using as models copies of material which appears to have originated in France. Some of these consist of bad copies of ancient Greek and Roman works in plaster negatives, perhaps intended for electro-forming.¹² Despite the poverty of his examples, Doble succeeded in injecting a spirited sweetness into his work. The backgrounds are well-drafted, having acutely observed foliage and other detail. The human figures, while well-proportioned and finished, are mannered in style. For example, a copper panel Diana and Acteon (19?)¹³ has accurately drawn trees, greenery and animals, but the figures could hardly be drawn from life, not even from well-made sculptures. The hands and feet are too elegant, the faces too stereotyped. In a circular copper plaque Cleopatra(?) at her Bath (19?)¹⁴, the figures again show the same mannered characteristics. The foliage in the jar is well-drawn, as is the

⁹ Ann Galbally, *The Collections of the National Gallery of Victoria*, Oxford University Press, Melbourne, 1987, illustrations 2.28, 2.31, 2.34, 2.41.

¹⁰ H.W. Janson, *A History of Art*, Thames and Hudson, London, 1986, pp.659, 661.

¹¹ McPhee, *op. cit.*, pp.48–49.

¹² Collection Anne Carolan, Sydney, NSW.

¹³ Collection Anne Carolan, Sydney, NSW.

¹⁴ Collection Anne Carolan, Sydney, NSW.

furniture. A question arises as to the true balance of the composition with an awkwardly placed statue in the background. A side table is distinctly Art Nouveau.

A circular plaque made by Doble for his friend and patron in Wellington, NSW, Murdoch McLeod, after 1933 shows a winged horse ridden by Apollo surrounded by *putti*.¹⁵ It is labelled Pegasus: Morel Ladeus (SS) (Illus.3). Again it is well-drawn, but the composition is cramped and busy, and again it has spirited sweetness, the charm of which is not subdued by the work's shortcomings.

The mannered figures in the plaques can also be found in a different context on Doble's trophies. One example shows a cricket match being played by figures with the same lissom limbs as his classical pieces.¹⁶ Doble's facility in 'doing figures' as a craftsman seems to have been built on a mixture of such sculptors as Canova, Clodion and Carpeaux, and such a painter as Fragonard. The most direct link can be found with Canova, his Tomb of the Archduchess Maria Christina (1798–1805) and Pauline Borghese as Venus (1808) (Illus.4 and 5). A painting by Charles Swaggers in 1833 of an engraving by Pietro Donato in 1805 (Illus.6) shows how the forms can be elided and softened. If such a work as this were used by Doble as a source for his neo-classical imagery, it would explain his mannered style.

A plaster plaque in the Art Gallery of New South Wales is a copy of an early Renaissance fresco, St Cecilia (191–). It does not display any of the characteristics of his neo-classical or Art Nouveau work.¹⁷

Doble's making of public monuments began with the Boer War Memorial (1909), Bathurst, NSW (Illus.7). He contracted to build the cupola designed by J.J. Copeman, and to make a standing figure and sculpted architectural ornaments for £620. Copeman's design bears some similarities to James White's Queen Victoria Monument, Melbourne (1903)

¹⁵ Collection Murdoch McLeod, Kingaroy, Queensland.

¹⁶ Collection Anne Carolan, Sydney, NSW. Unfortunately, the photograph seen in Carolan's collection was too small for detail to be seen.

¹⁷ Collection Art Gallery of New South Wales.

(Illus.8) in the arrangement of its corners, the cupola, the lions and columns. Copeman dispensed with the allegorical figures in the archways, put the main figure inside the structure and made a rusticated base. White's design is the more classically based with ionic capitals on his columns, and with a drum-shaped interior structure, all on a shallow platform.

Doble's figure is life-sized or slightly larger, with what appears to be well-observed details of uniform for the New South Wales Boer War trooper. It has been pointed out that the rifle appears to be badly observed, in that the butt does not lie in line with the barrel, necessary to absorb and transmit the recoil.¹⁸ However, mention has been made that the rifle was repaired at some time, though details are unavailable.¹⁹ The figure is balanced with even weight on the forward and backward foot, and facing in the direction in which the rifle is pointing. Except for the neck and possibly the size of the head which seem to be out of proportion, the figure is a realistic depiction of a tall trooper. Doble's original title for the figure was Breaker Morant, but Lord Kitchener refused to unveil it until the name was removed.²⁰ The plaque there now records the date of dedication in 1910.

At the other end of Kings Parade in Bathurst is Doble's Evans Memorial (1913–18) (Illus.9) commemorating the explorer's achievements in opening up the area west of the Great Dividing Range. The plinth is made in three levels of rusticated stone, set on a two-course base with abutting, semi-circular steps similarly of rusticated stone. Two semi-circular figure mounts of polished stone are at the right and left of the plinth at the second level. The same polished stone forms the cornices of the first and second levels of the plinth. Electro-formed copper plaque, frieze, fountain head and attached column adorn it.

¹⁸ Angus Sutherland, Wagga Wagga, NSW.

¹⁹ Bathurst Historical Society, NSW.

²⁰ Bathurst Historical Society, NSW.

There are four figures which make up the monument. Evans the explorer stands erect, with the figure of an Aborigine kneeling beside him. Both are placed as if looking over the plains. On the eastern side set on the figure mount is a male figure binding a sheaf of wheat representing Agriculture. The figure on the western side is a semi-clothed female figure representing Learning.²¹

The unity of the Evans Memorial comes from the common material, that of electro-formed copper, used for the figures and decorations. The Aborigine and Agriculture are naturalistic in treatment, as if worked from a model or a photograph. The figure of Evans is also naturalistic, but possibly derived from a figure on the Department of Lands building in Sydney made in the 19th century (Illus.10). The female figure is partly naturalistic, partly based on such work as Michelangelo's Day – Medici Chapel (1524–34).²²

Though anecdotal evidence says that Doble never used a model, with the figure of Agriculture, and to a lesser extent, the figure of the Aborigine, the directness of the modelling, the treatment of the details like skin and musculature and the posture of the torso are consistent with work from life. In his posture, with his absorption in his task, Agriculture can be compared with the goldminer in The Discovery of Gold (Illus.2).

The figure of the Aborigine is well-drawn, but of a different character to its companion in the group, Evans. Where the kneeling figure combines accuracy of observation and posture to evince an anecdotal interest, the figure of the explorer seems a stock figure, representative of the expanding Empire. The similar figure on the Department of Lands building is carved from sandstone and more refined in treatment than Doble's, where both Agriculture and the Aborigine show well-observed drawing, the figure of Evans has a head rather too large for the body.

²¹ Bathurst Historical Society, NSW.

²² Janson, *op. cit.*, p.455.

The female figure bears little relation to the light, free, mannered figures of Doble's decorative plaques. Here he worked to develop monumentality while retaining the strong femininity which was evident in all his work. The result is a strong frame adorned with a naturalistic treatment of the breasts, rather than the stylised 'globes' often accorded to classical and neo-classical figures. However, the modelling of the neck is over-long and distinctly cylindrical in form. It is not naturalistic at all. The head appears to be modelled on depictions of young women in popular art. Though having affinities to figures in Burne-Jones' The Golden Stairs (detail) (1880) (Illus.11) and The Beguiling of Merlin (1874) (Illus.12), Doble's figure lacks their grace. He no doubt felt constrained by the greater need for monumental form, but lacked the ability at this stage to convey grace as well.

With the diversity of approach to the figures in the Evans Memorial, Doble has negated any sense of unity. However, confidence in his ability to complete large public monuments was firmly established.

In the years 1918–19 to 1923, Doble completed three war memorials in Sydney, NSW, and made the garden and plinth in Wellington, NSW.

First to be completed was the Marrickville War Memorial in 1919 (Illus.13). It is an electro-formed figure mounted on a plinth in the form of a Corinthian column set on a plain base buttressed by simplified volutes. The whole is set on a platform with low walls, and stepped openings on each side.

With his "Winged Victory", Doble was drawing on the classical tradition of the *Nike* (Illus.14, 15, 16, 17, 18). The Monuments des Girondins, Bordeaux (18—) (Illus.19) is an example of 19th century usage. British monuments made at the same time as Doble's using the winged figure of victory, often holding a wreath and a sword, were common (Illus.20, 21,

22, 23). There is no record that Doble was directly influenced by the 20th century work, but it is possible for him to have known of the Girondins.

His Victory is made as if alighting from flight, holding up a sword, and offering a wreath to the observer. Once again, he has emphasised monumentality to gain presence. Burne-Jones' figures could again have been influential, especially the figure in The Beguiling of Merlin. Doble's figure is draped as if to evoke the classical, but the treatment does not follow the classical method. The fabric does not seem to be disturbed by the wind of her flight, so strikingly used in the Nike of Samothrace, and contributes a particularly static feel to the work. In comparison, English "Victory" statues (Illus.20–23) show draperies moved by forward motion.

At the time the Marrickville figure was to be installed, Doble submitted a design for a war memorial to Pyrmont Municipal Council for approval (Illus.24). The Pyrmont War Memorial (1920) again is a Victory. Now she holds a shield with the words "Their Name Liveth for Ever". Again the posture of her legs supposes she is landing from flight, but again the draperies are static. This Victory rather more successfully melds monumentality with feminine grace.

The plinth has a domed top, with a plain base buttressed by unadorned triangular forms at the corners. It is of dressed stone, and stands on a rusticated monolithic base.

In 1920, Doble submitted his design to the Wellington War Memorial Committee's competition. This he won, with a prize of £100, and contracted to make a garden, gates, plinth and statue for £3000²³ (Illus.25). The monument was to be as if a wall, supporting a three figure allegorical group at the centre, the sides were to carry the names plaques, and a copper bas-relief was to be set in the wall under the sculpture, and at the top of a set of steps. The wall-plinth design had distinct affinities to domestic architectural design (Illus.28).

²³ *The Wellington Times*, May 6, 1920.

Dressed stone pillars and pediment in the Californian bungalow style surrounded rusticated walls, and lights were to be set at each end of the monument. It is not clear from the drawing if the monument was to have a plain back.

The plinth which was dedicated in 1923 is quite different, and the sculptural group was not installed and dedicated until 1933. The bas-relief was not made, and the name plaques became vertical instead of horizontal. There is no record of the reason for Doble's departure from the accepted design, but his patron Murdoch McLeod was closely associated with the project, and may have had some influence on the changes.

The Leichhardt War Memorial was dedicated in 1922 in front of the Leichhardt Town Hall (Illus.26). It was moved to Pioneer Park in 1944. Here a simplicity necessitated by the lack of money prefigured the eventual simplicity of the Wellington War Memorial. A plain four-sided plinth in the form of a truncated obelisk of dressed but not polished stone supports a small copper female figure, symbolizing perhaps peace or victory. She carries a palm branch and carries an object which is now unidentifiable. In contrast to the Marrickville and Pyrmont figures, which are over life size, the Leichhardt figure appears to be half life size. The plinth is hardly big enough to accommodate the name plaques from both World War One and World War Two, as well as individual plaques for heroism.

Even in Doble's oeuvre, this is a weak figure. It has the drawing faults of the Bathurst figures, with a vapid line that has none of the strength of the figure Learning in Bathurst.

There is a sociological significance in Doble's use of electro-forming. Sculptors such as Bertram McKennal had to send their models to Europe to be cast in bronze, as there were no foundries in Australia. The electro-forming method was used in jewellery, silversmithing and industry, and is a 'cold' process. The relatively low cost and the local manufacture put sculptures and objects made this way within the reach of even the poorest communities.²⁴

²⁴ Carolan, *op. cit.*, p.44.

Pymont, Marrickville and Leichhardt were, in part still are, among the poorest areas of Sydney. Doble's accessibility allowed them to make what was to them a fitting tribute to the dead and wounded from their communities.

The monument which he was to regard as his best work²⁵, and which is certainly the most unified in conception is the Wellington War Memorial (1923–33).

²⁵ Carolan, *loc. cit.*

THE MEMORIAL

The memorial is part of an overall garden design which includes garden beds, paths, trees, a mound, a large gate, a fence along the boundary of the park, a large stone plinth and a three-figure group made of electro-formed copper¹ (Illus.27).

The sculpture has as its centre a female figure seated on a throne with an unsheathed sword on her lap, portraying a 'Winged Victory' or a *Nike*. The partly armoured figure on the viewer's left is, from the sculptor's description "a martial figure, symbolizing the spirit in which Australia went into the war"². She holds a knife in her left hand and a palm branch in her right. The supporting figure on the other side "represents History recording in a book the deeds of those who saw service"³. Another description is that the figure on the left is the Spartan mother, sword on lap (sic) recalling the injunction to her son "to return either carrying his shield or to be borne upon it", and the figure on the right is Cleo, the muse of history recording in a book the names of the fallen⁴.

The plinth has attached to it on the eastern face in the centre the words TO OUR GLORIOUS DEAD. Below that are three long metal plaques with the names of the dead from that district in World War One. Near the base is a small plaque marking the unveiling of the statue in 1933. On the buttressing walls are the years of the beginning and end of World War Two and two smaller plaques with the names of the dead from that war. On the western face of the central pillar is a laurel wreath, with the words PRO PATRIA in metal letters. On the lower part of the pillar in metal letters is the inscription ERECTED BY THE PEOPLE OF WELLINGTON IN REMEMBRANCE OF THE BRAVE. The date is below that – MCMXXXIII.

¹ Interview, Bathurst Historical Society, no transcript, 1993.

² Notation, Wellington Historical Society.

³ Notation, Wellington Historical Society.

⁴ Stanley Douglas, report, Wellington R.S.L. Sub-Branch.

Doble had designed the whole setting, leaving in situ only the 19th century Italian fountain which is to the south-east of the memorial in Cameron Park next to the Bell River⁵. Part of the garden design is a fence marking the boundary between the garden and the roadway. There is a metal plaque marking its completion in 1924. The gateway from the road to the path in front of the monument has a double carriage gate, with two side gates all set into four pillars. They were dedicated by Murdoch McLeod to the men who served in the Great War 1914–1918.

Both the statue and the gates face due east. The rising sun would play no part in the design except at those times of the year the sun rises due east. In April and November, the two months with most significance for war remembrance ceremonies, the sun rises somewhat north of that.

The statue was restored by Victor Cusack in 1989–90 at the Fine Art Foundry in Sydney at a cost of \$5836⁶. Green paint was removed at that time⁷. In 1991, Vanessa Hoheb of the Art Gallery of New South Wales repaired a finger which had broken off⁸.

The group with Doble's other memorials is unusual in Australian war memorial imagery in using the female figure. Only 0.9 percent of World War One memorials in Australia used the female figure⁹, whereas in other combatant countries, a female figure was quite common, whether as allegory, myth or factual depiction¹⁰. K.S. Inglis addresses the question in reference to the Australian War Memorial¹¹, as well as memorials in general¹².

⁵ Wellington Historical Society, interview 1993, no transcript.

⁶ Douglas, *op. cit.*

⁷ Stanley Douglas, interview 1993, no transcript.

⁸ Vanessa Hoheb, Art Gallery of New South Wales, interview 1993, no transcript.

⁹ K.S. Inglis and Jock Phillips, *War Memorials in Australia and New Zealand: A Comparative Survey*, in John Rickard and Peter Spearritt (eds.), *Packaging the Past: Public Histories*, Melbourne University Press, Carlton, 1991, p.182.

¹⁰ Derek Boorman, *At the Going Down of the Sun: British First War Memorials*, William Sessions Ltd., The Ebor Press, York, 1988, p.63, pp.137–140. June Sutherland interview 1993, no transcript (visit to France).

¹¹ K.S. Inglis, *A Sacred Place: the making of the Australian War Memorial*, *War and Society* Vol.3, p.120.

¹² K.S. Inglis, *Men, Women and War Memorials: Anzac Australia*, *Daedalus* Vol.116 No.4, pp.35–59.

The Plinth

A search for artistic influences on Doble's work must be made in the light of his isolation both from the centres of art in Europe and from the central concerns of accepted artists. As a stonemason, he was a craftsman who achieved fluency in drawing and modelling, and who had mastered the technique of electro-forming large pieces of copper.

With the plinth, he had departed both from the styles of his previous monuments and from the design he submitted to the Wellington War Memorial Committee in 1920.

At first sight, with the date of the final dedication of the monument in 1933 in mind, the plinth could be defined as Art Deco. It has quality of material and craftsmanship, combined with a simplicity and monumentality of design. Well-known young sculptors such as Raynor Hoff, and architects such as Bruce Dellit were commissioned to make their Art Deco designs for war memorials in Sydney, Canberra and Adelaide, and could be sources for a Sydney-based craftsman-sculptor like Doble.¹³ Further, the Dubbo War Memorial was designed by Raynor Hoff, and is a mere fifty kilometres away, dedicated in 1925. Raynor Hoff arrived in Sydney in 1923.¹⁴ But the plinth was built and dedicated by 1923. The design features can thus be placed more securely in the Art Nouveau style.

The plinth shows a complete change of style in Doble's work, in comparison both with his previous monuments and with the design approved by the War Memorial Committee in Wellington (Illus.25).

His first municipal work, the Boer War Memorial – Bathurst, NSW (Illus.7), was designed by the architect J.J. Copeman. Doble contracted to build the cupola, and to provide a copper figure to his own design.

¹³ Sturgeon, Graeme, *The Development of Australian Sculpture, 1788–1975*, p.98.

¹⁴ Sturgeon, *loc. cit.*

The Evans Memorial – Bathurst, NSW (Illus.9) he designed completely, including the plinth. It is of rusticated sandstone, with a central two part plinth supported on a two level base. Small, semi-circular steps abut the base on all four sides. On the east and west sides are attached two semi-circular supports made from dressed stone, intended for the allegorical figures. The same material is used for the architraves on the two upper levels. Attached to the stone plinth are metal plaques, frieze, attached columns and a simulated fountain head. The overall effect is in the 19th century style where mixed features were intended to give an accumulated grandeur. It adopts the rustication of the base of the Boer War Memorial at the other end of the park.

The Marrickville War Memorial, NSW (Illus.13) makes visual reference to such French memorials as Le Monuments des Girondins – Bordeaux (18—) (Illus.18) where a 'Victory' surmounts a Corinthian column supported on a neo-classical base. Doble's design in Marrickville is more modest in conception, supporting its Corinthian column on a plain base with stylised volutes on each corner. This base is placed on three steps, which in turn are set on a platform with fence and steps on each side. There is a marked lack of proportion in comparison with the Girondins. Doble has made his figure and column equal in height, whereas the figure on the French monument is approximately one third the height of the column. 'Victory' figures on monuments in Great Britain, however, used proportions similar to Doble's, though set on a plinth, not a column.¹⁵

The Pymont War Memorial – NSW (Illus.24) has a plinth moving away from the classical, though the figure it supports is in the French neo-classical mode. Here a plain central 'column' made of dressed stone with a domed top is supported on four corners by undecorated buttresses. The plinth is set on a circular, rusticated base. More balanced and

¹⁵ Boorman, *op. cit.*, p.138, p.137, p.134, p.98.

unified in design than the Marrickville work, the Pyrmont monument shows a transitional form – its figure referring to the past, and its plinth 'modern' in conception.

The Leichhardt War Memorial – NSW (Illus.26) is simpler in form than Doble's other work, perhaps because of the poverty of the community that commissioned it. However, its necessary simplicity has achieved a monumental dignity, despite its modest size. The base is in the form of a plain cenotaph, rising in a single movement to support the triple base under the copper figure. The plinth is set on a simple, light platform of two shallow steps. Though covered with the plaques of names of servicemen and woman, the plinth's simplicity is evident, and foreshadows the plinth in Wellington.

The design accepted by the Wellington War Memorial Committee in 1920 shows both the move to the modern style of the time, and the expansiveness possible with the comparatively large amount of money available. The masonry of the memorial was to serve the double purpose of being a frame for the bas-relief at the base and a support of the copper group above. With its rusticated walls framed by dressed stone, the proposed monument showed distinct correspondences with the new domestic architecture of the Californian bungalow (Illus.28). The sculptural group of the 'Victory' and two supporting figures were to be set on a square platform in the centre of what appeared to be a wall. At the ends of the wall were to be lamps made of three globes on metal frames. Three steps were to rise to the bas-relief. For an unknown reason, Doble continued only with the sculptural group, designing a more refined, more monumental plinth, and discarding the concept of the bas-relief.

In the Wellington plinth, Doble has made a dignified design, pared to its essentials, but rich in materials and finish. It has a central plinth approximately two and a half metres high flanked by two buttressing walls at a lower level. Polished granite forms the main part, with a dressed stone architrave and base. Facing east and west, it has a balanced form,

approached on both sides by three stone steps rising from the gravel of the mound on which it set.

The plinth has attached to it on the eastern face in the centre the words TO OUR GLORIOUS DEAD. Below that are three long metal plaques with the names of the dead from the district in World War One. Near the base is a small plaque marking the unveiling of the statue in 1933. On the buttressing walls are the years of the beginning and end of World War Two and two smaller plaques with the names of the dead from that war. On the western face of the central pillar is a laurel wreath, with the words PRO PATRIA in metal letters. On the lower part of the pillar in metal letters is the inscription ERECTED BY THE PEOPLE OF WELLINGTON IN REMEMBRANCE OF THE BRAVE. The date is below that – MCMXXIII.

Elements of Doble's sculptures, such as conformation of the figures and details of dress in the Evans, Leichhardt and the Wellington Memorial show an interest in Art Nouveau. As a self-taught artist-craftsman in an era when Art Nouveau had permeated popular design in Western society, it was natural perhaps that his work reflected the mode in response to his market. His use of Art Nouveau in the Wellington Memorial came after the end of its influence in Europe in 1914¹⁶, and was unusual in being applied to sculpture¹⁷.

He may have had access to copies of The Studio which showed garden designs at the Mannheim Exhibition by Professor Max Läger (Illus.29), or war memorials by Einar Jonssen (Illus.30 and 31).

The elements which the plinth displays can be found in architectural designs by Charles Rennie Mackintosh in the Glasgow School of Art (1907–1909) (Illus.32), Joseph Hoffmann Palais Stoclet – Brussels (1905–1914) (Illus.33), Henry van der Velde Théâtre des

¹⁶ Alastair Macintosh, *Symbolism and Art Nouveau*, Thames and Hudson, London, 1975, p.57.

¹⁷ Macintosh, *id.*, p.56.

Champs Elysées – Paris (1911–1913) (Illus.34). In particular, Palais Stoclet with its fine stone cladding, clean lines and stepped pyramid forms projects the same simplicity, quality of materials and workmanship as the plinth.

The European Art Nouveau architects had adopted Rennie Mackintosh's approach to design with form following function, rather than academic standards imposed without regard to human use.¹⁸ The Secession Building – Vienna, Joseph Olbrich (Illus.35), seen by the Secessionist as a 'temple' to the possibilities of art, and the completion of a dream of the French Nabis ten years earlier¹⁹, was admired for its austerity and simple volumes. By adopting proportions displayed in such a building, Doble could then be making a statement of the same values as the Viennese Art Nouveau artists. However, there is no record that he was aware of the building.

While the design for the *Théâtre des Champs Elysées* was based on an idea by Henry van der Velde, Auguste Perret who constructed it contributed his own interpretation. His major concern was to move away from the heavy 19th century composite styles, and the mode of Art Nouveau, and to project a new honesty and simplicity of style. His contemporary Tony Garnier wrote "Truth alone is beautiful. In architecture, truth is the result of calculations made to satisfy known necessities with known materials". Adolf Loos had said "Ornament is crime". Le Corbusier worked in Perret's office in 1908 and regarded the classical epoch as decadent. The design of the building with its smooth surfaces and sharp edges, expressed a concern with authenticity and sincerity, rather than pretence and hypocrisy.²⁰ Here is a change in approach that may have appealed to Doble as being French, and modern.

¹⁸ Macintosh, *id.*, p.51.

¹⁹ Jean-Paul Bouillon, *Klimt: Beethoven – The Frieze for the Ninth Symphony*, Skira Rizzoli, New York, 1987, pp.14–16.

²⁰ Modris Eksteins, *Rites of Spring: The Great War and the Birth of the Modern Age*, Bantam Press, London, 1989.

The design by Einar Jonssen which may have had some influence on Doble was that of a war memorial or victory memorial published in The Studio in 1919 (Illus.37). Though more complex in execution than the Wellington Memorial, they nevertheless depart from the classical, and give models for imposing public sculptures. More prosaically, Max Läger's design for garden walls in 1907 show the same sense of mass stripped of ornament.

The Cenotaph – London (1919) by Edward Lutyens was first, temporary installation in Whitehall. Its grandeur and simplicity deeply impressed the public, and it was widely copied in England (Illus.36). Pictures of it were possibly published in Australia. It was one of the few important war memorials to pre-date Doble's work, and possibly the only one to be publicized in Australia.

It is unknown what influences worked on Doble in making the change from the original design. Certainly he was working closely with his friend and patron in Wellington, Murdoch McLeod who had been a sea captain, and travelled widely. Along with his knowledge of the wider world, he may have had a discerning eye. What is sure is the secure design which eventuated in Wellington.

Pictures of the plinth in the ten year period before the installation of the sculptural group show a monumental force, recalling both an altar, and a cenotaph or empty tomb (Illus.41). In Australia, the concept of the empty tomb was a poignant reminder of the 'presence of absence'²¹, the graves far away in Europe²², and not in Australia.

²¹ W. Clements, interview 1993, no transcript.

²² Mosse, *op. cit.*, p.93; Inglis, *Men, Women and War Memorials*, p.36.

The Names

K.S. Inglis raises the issue of the significance of Australian First World War Memorials and the record of names. Almost alone in WW1 memorial practice, Australians inscribed all the names of those who 'saw service'. He suggests that in part this was to record, by their absence, the names of those who did not volunteer. In the main, it was seen as important that the volunteers – again, Australia was unique in having an entirely volunteer force – should be honoured as heroes. It was, and still is, thought that lives freely given had the extra cachet of sacrifice of the highest order.

In Wellington, the names of the volunteers are in another place, the names on the memorial being those who died, could the inscription on the western side of the memorial be a veiled reference to those who were not brave? Perhaps not – a positive dedication to the boys who did not return is more comfortable, and more likely.

Dates of Dedication

The western face of the pillar carries the date 1923 in Roman numerals made of copper and attached separately. It marks the dedication of the plinth. The small plaque on the eastern face marks the unveiling in 1933 of the statue group by Mrs. Barton, a senior member of a local landowning family whose son died in Palestine.

The Laurel Wreath

The laurel wreath on the monument is made of copper. It is a formalized design with the closely massed leaves bound with a file. Its position on the opposite side of the monument to the names of the dead juxtaposed with 'PRO PATRIA' and '...FOR THE BRAVE' speak of an assertion of the glory, the sacrifice and the victory. In contrast, the names of the dead on the eastern front speak of the need for a substitute grave.

The laurel wreath has significance both as a fitting accolade for heroes, and for its sacrificial and funerary connotations in ancient Greek practice.

Laurus nobilis, the sweet bay, or laurel was the sacred tree of Apollo, Greek god of the sun, music, poetry, prophecy, agriculture and rural life. Myrtle branches and wreaths formed part of the accoutrements of funerary sacrifice in ancient Greece. Both the battle and the burial were reenacted in the ceremony. The Greeks saw war as a sacrifice. "The created and consecrated monument is what endures, and it embodies the duty of the following generation."

Victorious Roman generals were crowned with laurel wreaths, and their soldiers decorated their helmets and spears with the leaves, and carried bunches of laurel.

PRO PATRIA

Each of the letters is made of copper and set separately on the granite. They are Roman in form.

After Federation, there were many in Australia who saw England as home. Many men, in fact, were English by birth and had come to Australia to work or find land. Even among republicans, there was no doubt of the reality and power of the British Empire. Men such as Henry Lawson saw no conflict in believing both in Australia's independence and in Australian's duty to fight for the King.

Wellington demonstrated in its overwhelming response to the call to arms its belief in King and Country. Beginning with the Coo-ee March which started in Gilgandra and went through Dubbo and Wellington on the city in 1915, the men of the area did not hold back. In fact the march forced the Army to accept them because at that time it did not want untrained men going to the front. Numbers of men may have been inflated in comparison with other country towns because of the gold mine and the flour mill, as the railway works did in

Nimmitabel, N.S.W. Nevertheless, 895 men from a total population of 3900 is certainly significant. The Second Vale of Tempe gave its all.

The Mound

The mound had been raised on a level part of the garden, so that a path and grass could be set with a generous sweep around it. The mound is a flattened circular tumulus, approximately half a metre high, covered with grass, except for the gravel path around the monument. It has cut into it on the east and west sides a set of three steps as approaches to the area on top of it.

A mound can be a reference to the ancient Greek practice of gathering the bones of the fallen in battle, burning the flesh – part of funerary rites – and forming a mound over them.²³ (Illus.42). A commemorative statue was sometimes raised above it, and it became a site for hero worship.

In a photograph of the plinth and its mound in 1926, the mound is more complex in shape. It had the form of an oblong lying east-west, with semi-circular additions to the north and south sides (Illus.41). Perhaps the shape was too difficult to maintain, or erosion damaged the well-defined modelling. This original shape and the way it was made with such precision fitted with the overall Art Nouveau style of the monument.

The carefully formed mound in Wellington is surely done with some purpose, but there is no record of Doble's intention in this respect.

²³ Hans Georg Wunderlich, trans. Richard Winston, *The Secret of Crete*, Souvenir Press, London, 1975, pp. 231, 241.

The Garden

The garden setting is made between the bank of the Bell River and the main street of the town. Within this space in Cameron Park are formal paths and garden beds surrounding the mound on which the monument is set. The formal garden leads to a planting of large trees to the west, and to the south, the banks of the river. To the south east of the monument is the 19th century Italian fountain retained by Doble in his design.

The garden as part of a funerary or commemorative design had its origins in the English landscape garden and the French Elysium, or Field of Rest in the 18th century²⁴ both of which draw on the sense of landscape as theatre.

Jackson proposed that in the 16th and 17th centuries, Western man first began imposing order on nature, making visible the status of relationships between men in the world, and between mankind and nature. He says of landscape as theatre that it

emphasized the visual, the spectacular aspects of the environment, but it also suggested a spectacle in the sense of a dramatic production with a well-defined space, an organization of place and time, and coherent action²⁵.

Related to this view is the 18th century idea of nature being the embodiment of God's immensity, derived in part from Joseph Addison's joining of the experiential and the theological²⁶. In his modifications of Le Nôtre's design at Versailles in the early 18th century, Switzer aimed at "artificial rudeness", "serpentine meanders" and a "tall, stately and bold effect".²⁷ One of his preferred methods of placing a boundary was to establish a canal or

²⁴ Richard A. Etlin, *The Architecture of Death*, MIT Press, Mass., 1984, p.163.

²⁵ J.B. Jackson, "Landscape as Theatre", *Landscape*, 23(1), 1979, p.4.

²⁶ Etlin, *op. cit.*, p.163.

²⁷ Etlin, *loc. cit.*

watercourse²⁸. His designs enabled enjoyment of both the controlled garden area and, in looking "forward and backward", the wider untamed view beyond.²⁹

The improved landscape was seen then even in its business aspects of enhancing productivity as a reflection of God's beneficence. The creation of a new view was to Switzer a way of finding harmony for the maker, as well as profit. The garden became an environment for spiritual experience.³⁰

In this vein, the English practice of building commemorative monuments in the landscape was a natural extension. The metaphor of spirituality in the experience of the landscape would intensify the reflective nature of the monument. In France, landowners not only adopted this practice, but set graves in the gardens. With the influence of Gessner's writings *Idylls* and *New Idylls*, widely read in the second half of the 18th century, the connection of mourning with the landscape was instrumental in the adoption of landscaped settings for cemeteries in the city.³¹ The tomb became an indispensable part of the Arcadian landscape. Saint-Pierre wrote that the tomb links this world with the next.³²

The melancholy and feeling of pathos generated by the solemn contemplation of tombs were seen as a profound spiritual experience. Memorials to worthy public figures such as Captain Cook were also seen as suitable objects of contemplation. The honour due to his achievements, the tragedy of his death were likely sources of virtuous thoughts. At Méréville, where the monument to Cook is combined with a memorial to the Duc Jean-Joseph de Laborde's two sons who died on La Perouse's voyage, the setting is a solitary part of the garden – "the most shaded and the most savage" – on the banks of a stream, with plantings of exotic trees to recall a far-off land.³³

²⁸ Etlin, *op. cit.*, p.167.

²⁹ Etlin, *loc. cit.*, p.167.

³⁰ Etlin, *ibid.*, p.170.

³¹ Etlin, *ibid.*, p.200.

³² Etlin, *loc. cit.*

³³ Etlin, *op. cit.*, p.224.

Abbé Delille in his poem Les Jardins (1782) and Bernardin de Saint-Pierre in his Etudes de la Nature (1784) shared a common view that the pastoral and elegaic garden had a moral force, and that gardens for decoration such as the *jardin anglo-chinois* were empty of content.³⁴

The funerary garden as Elysium as a connection between this world and the next in the 18th century set a tone adopted by both the Park Cemetery Movement in America, and a similar practice in Germany. From a general community style, special cemeteries for the fallen war evolved, particularly the German *Heldenhaine* or "Heroes Grove".³⁵

Common both to the 18th century Arcady and the 19th century Grove for Heroes is that the garden setting withdraws the whole to another plane of being, away from the mundane. In this, the garden performs as theatre, creating a metaphor for existence. In a practical sense, the garden widens the perspective of the monument, drawing the eye both to a focus and to a wider horizon.

Doble's garden design had identifiable correspondences with the funerary and memorial garden aesthetic of the 18th century. He has set it on the banks of a stream. The paths which approach the site of the memorial "meander", with vistas opening between trees. The garden was set originally so that the rough country beyond could be seen and enjoyed at the same time (Illus.41). The memorial functions both as a cenotaph and as a vehicle for contemplation about the moral virtues, fulfilling its rôle as a point of junction between this world and the next. A boundary fence and gate to the street mark the division between the separated space of the garden from the everyday world.

³⁴ Etlin, *ibid.*, p.210.

³⁵ Mosse, *op. cit.*, p.88.

An example in New South Wales of a garden as memorial in itself is the Victory Memorial Garden, Wagga Wagga (1928). While there is a cenotaph, it was not conceived originally as part of the garden design. It had been made in 1922–23, while the gardens were made in 1928. Here a garden is set beside water, with a space separated from the mundane. However, in its original function as an enhanced setting for a parade ground as can be seen in the original design,³⁶ it departs somewhat from Doble's expression. The separation in Wagga of cenotaph and garden was epitomized in a court action between the two committees responsible.³⁷

Simple as it may be, the garden setting for the Wellington War Memorial embodies elements which together must signal considered intent on the part of the designer.

The Gate

The gate is set facing east in line with the eastern face of the monument (Illus.44). Two pillars approximately two to three metres high support a double gate of wrought iron. Set into the gate are dedication plaques, Murdoch McLeod's initials, Australian Army badge replicas, a Victory wreath with entwined dates of the war, and decorative bosses and knobs. The side gates have the initials, bosses and knobs, and close on a latch against two pillars approximately two metres high.

Art Nouveau elements can be seen in the entwined year numbers at the top of the main gates, and in the "M.M." initials. The bosses are stylized flowers set in circular mounts framed by arabesque shapes.

³⁶ Parks and Gardens, Wagga Wagga City Council, plan.

³⁷ W. Stegemann, "We Will Remember Them: the significance of first world war memorials in south-eastern New South Wales 1919–39", *Journal of the Australian War Memorial*, No. 4, 1984, p.27.

The turned knobs, together with all the decorations, show a high degree of finish and fine craftsmanship.

The letters "A.I.F." in the badge roundel are stylized plant forms, of the Art Nouveau type. The rising sun badge has on it "Australian Commonwealth Military Force", not "Australian Imperial Force", the name of the World War One Australian Army. The roundel is framed with a decoration of leaves, possibly laurel.

There are examples of gates designed by William Morris' company which may have given Doble a model for his design (Illus.43), but a more closely related design is, for example, a set of gates at the Town Hall Building, Melbourne. They have more formality than Morris' designs, related to the 19th century neo-classical of the Melbourne building. However, Doble added motifs which declare an adoption of Art Nouveau styles.

The gate was paid for and dedicated to the soldiers by the owner of the flour mill, Captain Murdoch McLeod.

The Fence

The fence marks the boundary of the part of the garden designed by Doble (Illus.45). It is made of cast cement in a simplified swag design between posts approximately two metres apart. The intervening panels have three oblong chisel-shaped indents as decoration.

A commemorative metal plaque records

Erected 1924

Jas. A. Preston

Mayor

W.A. Miller

J.A. Redman

Town Clerk

Overseer

The simplified forms recall shapes from houses of the period, with the dipped balustrade on some brick houses, and on fences. However, the effect is far from domestic, and the fence is dignified and suitable for its status as part of a war memorial.

Summary of Significance

It is unclear if the people of Wellington were fully aware of the implications and the meaning of the different elements of their war memorial. It is not even clear if Gilbert Doble was aware of them. However, the concentrated use of classical motifs suggest a definite plan and significant meaning.

Looking at it for the first time, the strongly militaristic impetus behind it is not immediately obvious. Rather, the quiet posture of the central winged figure seems to show mourning, an angel perhaps, reflecting on the sad loss of lives. But the sword on her knees is unsheathed, and the supporting figures are not of a funerary nature.

While the garden setting recalls cemeteries and commemoration of the dead, with the iconography of the monument, the garden takes on the tenor of a grove for heroes.

With their history of a deep commitment to the war, the people of Wellington needed a suitably imposing commemorative object. This they had in the plinth for ten years. The completion of the monument gave them an image unusual in Australia, and of a non-Christian, a 'pagan' form. Such issues were important then. The form of prayer for the dedication created heated discussion³⁸. People of that time had suspicions about pagan, non-Christian practices, going so far in England as to reject crosses as memorials as they were regarded as idolatrous³⁹. Even the hallowed Classical world was regarded with doubt in this

³⁸ K.S. Inglis, "Great War Memorials" in *Australian Cultural History*, Vol. 6, pp.13–14.

³⁹ K.S. Inglis, *The Hallowing: The War Memorial Movement in Cambridge, England* in *Journal of Contemporary History*, Vol.27 No.4, 1992, pp.594–5.

respect. The reluctance of the population to have the statue can perhaps be explained in this way, even though the explanation in the local history is that they preferred an obelisk⁴⁰.

The strong commitment to proper commemoration in Wellington can be seen in the invitation to C.E.W. Bean to give an Anzac Day address in 1931 (Illus.46). Bean, official war correspondent and war historian, was influential in guiding and setting the form of Anzac Day commemorations⁴¹. His presence in Wellington tied the depth of their feeling to the wider practices of commemoration and consolidation of memory in the rest of Australia.

⁴⁰ D.I. McDonald, *They Came to a Valley: Wellington, NSW 1817–1967*, Wellington Times Commercial Printing Department, Wellington, 1968, p.173.

⁴¹ K.S. Inglis, "A Sacred Place: The Making of the Australian War Memorial" in *War and Society*, Vol.3 No.2, 1985, pp.102–3. ANZAC Day Movement originated with Archdeacon Garland in Brisbane — John Moses, St Lucia, Queensland, 1993.

THE STATUE

The sculptural group that forms part of the War Memorial at Wellington has several identifiable influences; the Classical, Art Nouveau, Pre-Raphaelite, popular art in Australia, the Italian Renaissance, and the Baroque. (Illus.27)

Doble has based his sculpture on Ancient Greek myth and legend. The group's subject is a Victory, with two supporting figures, one the Australian war-like spirit or a Spartan mother, the other the allegorical figure of History. However, he has departed from both the tenor of his own work with 'Victories' and the usual cast of *Nike* statues. This winged figure is at rest, seated, with a naked sword on her lap. In Doble's previous 'Victories', the figure is in flight, or just alighting, holding a sword and a laurel wreath. The Classical representations are of an active figure, even in the case of the unusual Nike adjusting her sandal or Athens Nike (c.410–407 BC) (Illus.17). The Nike of Samothrace (c.200–190 BC) Paris has its own vital expression of forward movement (Illus.16). Further back in time, the archaic Nikes are clearly active with wings spread in flight and limbs indicating movement (Illus.14).

With the quiet posture in the central figure, the wings have an odd inconsistency. Extended, they fill the need for a dramatic profile, but they do not fit with the idea of a winged creature at rest.

With the use of a winged figure to portray Victory, the emphasis is on spiritual worth. Disarming the enemy and his subsequent subjugation underlies the significance of the victory of arms. An added psychological element of victory in war is the conquering of the weakness in oneself¹.

¹ J.E. Cirlot, translated Jack Sage, *A Dictionary of Symbols*, Routledge and Kegan Paul, London, 1962, p.341.

To Plato, wings symbolized intelligence². If the statue is overlaid, in an eclectic fashion, with notions of Christian symbolism, the wings are the light of the sun of justice, illuminating the mind of the righteous³.

The sword has a rich heritage of symbolic meaning. In its form as a blade and a guard, it is a cross, a 'conjunction'. An iron sword was believed by the Romans to ward off evil spirits. Its prime meaning is as liberty and strength, in its implication of wounding. It was believed to ward off dark powers. The knight carried a sword as a defender of right against wrong, light against darkness. Alchemists believe the sword to be a symbol of purifying fire. Chrysaor, the golden sword in Greek mythology, was a symbol of supreme spiritualization⁴.

In Christian belief, the angel is a symbol of invisible forces moving between the 'Source-of-Life' and the World⁵. In Greek belief, winged figures were embodiments of ideas⁶.

In Doble's previous work, the figures were clothed in a much more Classical form. This Victory is dressed in a romanticized medieval gown over a chemise. She wears a diadem, but the hair is softly romantic, with swags over the ears, and a knot at the back of obviously abundant hair. Her bodice has a distinct Art Nouveau style, with a sinuous motif drawn from nature.

The face is modelled strongly and expresses quiet resolution and sadness.

Her throne is perhaps intended to be Greek. It has the curved lines to be found in the representations of chairs in ancient Greek decorative painting (Illus.47a and 47b). But it is also reminiscent of some more elaborate medieval styles seen in such works as Madonna Enthroned Duccio (1308–11) and Madonna Enthroned Cimabue (c.1280–90)⁷. Chiselled

² Cirlot, *ibid.*, p.355.

³ Cirlot, *loc. cit.*

⁴ Cirlot, *ibid.*, pp.307–308.

⁵ Cirlot, *ibid.*, p.9. James Hall, *Hall's Dictionary of Subjects and Symbols in Art*, John Murray, London, 1979, pp.16–17.

⁶ Jane Harrison, *Prolegomena to the Study of Greek Religion*, Cambridge, 1903–1922, reprint 1955, Chapter XII.

⁷ Janson, *op. cit.*, p.342.

forms cut a crisp outline with details to elaborate the Classical reference. A Greek key pattern frieze decorates the outer edge of the seat. The tops of the back panels and the armrest post have a profile reminiscent of Roman architecture. Stylized flower forms decorate the junction of the back panels with the seat. Though the legs of the throne are heavy and square in section, they echo in their curve the legs on chairs from Ancient Greece, such as in Grave Stele of Hegeso (c.410–400 BC) and White-ground lekythos with Mistress and Maid the Achilles Painter (c.440–430 BC)⁸. The throne is raised on a plinth within the metal group, severe in style, merely with a plain base, and an undecorated architrave.

The wreath the Victory would usually be carrying is on the western side of the granite support.

The female figure with the helmet is seated as if on the ground facing south. Though inadequately protected for battle, she appears resolute and ready for action. (Even though Greek soldiers were scantily clad, if not naked, they did have the advantage of a shield and a spear.) She holds a palm leaf (or a scourge?) in her right hand and a short sword in her left. Though with a long skirt impractical for war, her arms are free of encumbrance, bare. The helmet seems to be a simplified Italian Renaissance type, rather than the Classical Greek full helmet familiar from depictions of soldiers, for example *The Dying Warrior*, Aegina c.490 BC⁹, and Athena in war accoutrements as in *Athena and Alcyoneus – Altar of Zeus*, Pergamum (c.180 BC)¹⁰ (Illus.18).

The blouse, skirt and belt without the leather shielding, and with modest sleeves, could have been worn by any modern girl of the time. This is Diana in the modern world. With short hair, an athletic body and a strong face, she looks the epitome of an Amazon, or a war-like spirit.

⁸ Janson, *ibid.*, pp.136–137.

⁹ Janson, *ibid.*, p.117.

¹⁰ Janson, *ibid.*, p.145.

The figure of the recorder of deeds has a softer mien, as her task is more reflective than the others. Her face has a rather odd expression of concern. She holds a large book across her knees with a pen in her right hand. Contributing to the feeling of softness is the softness of the book, which follows her form, rather than being rigid. Her gown and cloak are in the medieval mode of the Pre-Raphaelites. Her hair is long, tied up in the Victorian manner with a woven file around her head.

All three figures are strongly modelled, with individual characteristics, both facial and in other details. Their affecting presence is conveyed by posture and facial expression. Popular art reflected and transmitted the way Australians saw themselves¹¹. Recruiting posters such as Take up the Sword of Justice¹² with its female figure in Classical garb are drawn with a face with the 'look' of the day. The figures in the Wellington Group do the same — their overall appearance is of the time, thoroughly modern without making any concessions to such modern sculptors as Rodin or Maillol.

An armed, winged, female figure could be 'read' easily in that era. Charles Ricketts' colour lithograph *Italia Redenta* made at the time of the First World War shows what appears to be a winged figure valiantly defending a population from a double-headed eagle¹³ (Illus.48).

With the sword on her lap, the Wellington Victory echoes the Michelangelo Pietà (1497–1500)¹⁴. While lacking the mastery of the Renaissance sculptor, Dobson nevertheless has his figure presenting the sword for our consideration, in sorrow and pride, just as does Mary with the body of her son. In both, the initial impact of the image carries with it an

¹¹ Michael McKernan, *The Australian People and The Great War*, Thomas Nelson Australia, Melbourne, 1980, p.184.

¹² Australian War Memorial.

¹³ Meirion and Susan Harries, *The War Artists: British Official War Art of the Twentieth Century*, Michael Joseph in association with the Imperial War Museum and the Tate Gallery, London, 1983, p.79.

¹⁴ Rudolf Wittkower, *Sculpture: Processes and Principles*, p.105 (find citation).

interpretative function – they stand for something more meaningful than the image alone suggests.

If the armoured figure is seen as the Spartan Mother, Doble is following a pattern he set with the Evans Memorial in Bathurst. There, also, he had a central motif with two supporting figures. As Agriculture and Knowledge, they are shown in two different idioms. Agriculture is a worker standing for the abstract idea of agriculture, as an anecdote. The female figure is wholly imaginary, having no basis in fact, standing for an idea in a poetic sense.

Enthronement with supporting figures occurs in early Christian art and continues through to the eighteenth and nineteenth centuries. For example, Christ Enthroned, a detail from Sarcophagus of Junius Bassus (c.359) shows Christ as Pantocrator between two figures standing on a lower plane.¹⁵ The Madonna Enthroned of Cimabue (c.1280–90),¹⁶ Duccio (1308–11)¹⁷ and Giotto (c.1310)¹⁸ have the central figures seated on a throne supported at the sides with attendant beings. The Ghent Altarpiece H. and J. van Eyck (1432) has the Lord between the Virgin and St. John the Baptist.¹⁹ Veneziano's Madonna and Child with Saints (c.1445)²⁰ and Bellini's Madonna and Saints (1505)²¹ both have the throne flanked by figures representing significant people and attributes. The Tomb of Giuliano de' Medici Michelangelo (1524–34) (Illus.49) has allegorical figures of Night and Day beneath but on either side of the idealized martial figure of Giuliano.²² Though of a fitting splendour for St. Peter's, Rome, The Throne of St. Peter Bernini (1657–66) is still the same pattern.²³ Canova in 1783–7 in a classicizing image for the Tomb of Pope Clement XIV (Illus.50) has the Pope

¹⁵ Janson, *op. cit.*, p.206.

¹⁶ Janson, *ibid.*, p.342.

¹⁷ Janson, *loc. cit.*

¹⁸ Janson, *ibid.*, p.349.

¹⁹ Janson, *ibid.*, pp.375 & 377.

²⁰ Janson, *ibid.*, p.416.

²¹ Janson, *ibid.*, p.431.

²² Janson, *ibid.*, p.455.

²³ Janson, *ibid.*, p.515.

represented as enthroned above two classically robed allegorical figures which, though stepped down from each other and the central figure, are still effectively flanking it.²⁴ In 1784 Sir Joshua Reynolds painted Mrs. Siddons as the Tragic Muse,²⁵ a heavily Romantic depiction, and sister to the Wellington monument in its use of highly fashionable, stylized Classical motifs.

If the armoured figure is seen as the Spartan Mother, Doble is following a pattern he set with the Evans Memorial in Bathurst. There, also, he had a central motif with two supporting figures. As Agriculture and Learning, they are shown in two different idioms. Agriculture is a worker standing for the abstract idea of agriculture, as an anecdote. The female figure is wholly imaginary, having no basis in fact, standing for an idea in a poetic sense.

In the Wellington monument, similarly, the Spartan Mother is based on a Greek legend which may have been based on fact. The allegorical figure of History represents an abstract concept alone.

With the Wellington War Memorial, Doble achieved unity, monumentality, grace and proportion. Evident in his previous work were examples of a lack of unity, infelicities of drawing and incompletely conceived designs. However, the elements which together constitute success in Wellington can be found in his other monuments, and even in his decorative plaques, which seem to bear so little relation to his sculptures.

Well-observed figures can be seen in his Agriculture, and in the uniform of the Boer War trooper. Grace is seen in his Pymont monument, and proportion is found in Agriculture and the Aborigine. Monumentality emerges in Learning of the Evans Memorial, and in the Marrickville War Memorial figure. His sources have become less idiosyncratic in their

²⁴ Wittkower, *op. cit.*, p.226.

²⁵ Janson, *op. cit.*, p.563.

mediation. In the Leichhardt War Memorial, the image has failed in its translation, relying rather too heavily on such a source as Burne-Jones and his ethereal ladies, rather than injecting some of his own raw strength evident in his other work. In his plaques, the fluent drawing of foliage shows close observation of natural forms, and ability to translate them to the bas-relief.

The plinths became more simplified, until the Wellington structure achieved unity in the architectural blend of monumentality and simplicity. Doble's success is in part due to the counterbalancing mass of granite under the complexity of the copper group.

In making a three-figure group of this nature, Doble is following both his own usage, and practice in funerary monuments in Europe. For instance, Tomb of Pope Clement XIV (1783) Canova shows a central enthroned figure performing a significant gesture. Below to left and right are mourning allegorical figures, placed so as to make a triple movement. Canova's format can be traced to Bernini's tombs of the popes, and his back to Michelangelo.²⁶ In Bernini's work, the Tomb of Pope Urban VIII, St. Peter's, Rome²⁷ and Tomb of Pope Alexander VII, St. Peter's, Rome²⁸, and in Della Porta's Tomb of Pope Paul III, St. Peter's, Rome²⁹, the figure of the deceased pope is set on a central plinth, flanked below by allegorical figures. All three adapt Michelangelo's setting in the Medici Chapel of the commemorative figure of Giuliano de Medici in a wall niche above a sarcophagus form on which are set two allegorical figures.

In keeping with the tone of Australia's war memorials being cenotaphs, or empty tombs, Doble's Wellington monument recalls such illustrious examples. Doble's Evans Memorial shows a central group making a significant gesture, with two attendant allegorical

²⁶ Erwin Panofsky; H. W. Janson (ed.), *Tomb Sculpture: Its Changing Aspects from Ancient Egypt to Bernini*, Thames and Hudson, London, 1964.

²⁷ Panofsky, fig. 437.

²⁸ Panofsky, fig. 440.

²⁹ Panofsky, fig. 438.

figures, with rather less of a musical progression than in Canova's work. The Wellington War Memorial has a Victory enthroned, showing us the naked sword in a significant gesture, a heavily mediated similarity to the Virgin's gesture in Pietà (1497–1500), Michelangelo (Illus.51).

With all the artistic influences evident in Doble's work, there is a certain *naïveté* in his adoption of them. For example, the disjunction in the expression of grace and monumentality in Learning, Evans Memorial and the Victory in the Marrickville War Memorial stands them apart from such parallels as Michelangelo's Day, Medici Chapel (1524–34) and Canova's mourning figures in his Tomb of the Archduchess Maria Christina (1798–1805). While Canova's figures Temperance and the other mourning figure can be seen as models for the figure of Learning, and History in the Wellington War Memorial, their singular grace has only been approximated even in the latter figure, one of Doble's successes.

The explorer's figure in the Evans Memorial has not caught the vitality of Agriculture in the same monument. In its similarity to the Department of Lands explorer figure, it seems to have drawn heavily on its influence, but lacks its subtlety of modelling.

With the figure of Learning, it is difficult to find a classical example of this type. Female figures in classical times were fully clothed, or showed a goddess bathing. Figures similarly clothed were pictured in representations of native peoples in the eighteenth and nineteenth centuries as noble savages. However, here is Learning, the supposed quintessence of a civilized allegorical figure dressed in the manner of the unlearned.

As discussed above, the draperies on Doble's Victories are uncharacteristic of fabric moved by wind, and as such are unresolved in design.

All these naive interpretations of Doble's drawn from past examples are almost entirely resolved in the Wellington monument. Not only are drawing problems overcome, but the depiction of the figure at rest has solved the problems of the drapery. This success does

not mean that he had to abandon all his past initiatives. It is evident that he has integrated them adequately to achieve unity. For example, he has used the posture of the hands of the figure of Learning and the Aborigine in the Spartan mother. Except for the different posture of the head and the addition of the book and different clothing, the figure of History is close to the female figure in the Evans Memorial.

The Wellington monument is the most completely unified design of Doble's, but there is still the inexplicable division of styles between the figure of the Spartan mother and the figure of History. It is similar to the profound difference in treatment between Agriculture and Learning in the Evans Memorial. There is then a sense that the central figure of Victory at Wellington is an amalgam of the two types, surely an unlooked-for result, but in the event a unifying factor. The faces of the figures most clearly illustrate this. The Spartan mother has a strong and distinctive facial structure; heavy brows, clear eyes, sensuous mouth. In contrast, the figure of History is softer in conception, closer to the neo-classical ideal, as well as the Pre-Raphaelite expression. The Victory's face succeeds in showing grave concern, and a sense of honour being made to the dead. Her face is gentle but commanding, compassionate and strong.

The Wellington Victory is a significant departure from the usual depictions of such winged figures. Though there are seated female figures in the British War Memorial catalogue, they are not winged.³⁰

Possibly available to Doble as examples were pictures of such sculptures as Rodin's The Call to Arms (1878) (Illus.52) and Le Monument des Girondins (18—) (Illus.18). Even such a figure as Hebe and the Eagle (1846) François Rude (Illus.53)³¹, which shows the eagle's wings about to enfold Hebe, giving a similar profile to a winged figure. The casts

³⁰ Derek Boorman, *op. cit.*, Fig. 105, **Fraserburgh Memorial**, Aberdeen.

³¹ Caroline Ward (Intr.), *Masterpieces from the Louvre*, Queensland Art Gallery, Brisbane, 1988, p.17.

were widely distributed outside France, and if available to Doble as a sculpture or in some other form of representation, could give a model for the interpretation of a winged figure. When looking at Doble's model for a suggested design for a war memorial, with its Victory alighting beside an Australian soldier, marked similarities in posture can be found (Illus.54).

The Spirit of History (1781) N. Gatteaux (Illus.55) has a seated figure writing in a book with an attendant standing winged figure. It depicts the Spirit of History interrupting History, and attracting her attention, possibly a representation of the recording of an event which could change the course of history. Could such a group have been known to Doble? He and Gatteaux were both medal makers, and allegorical subjects were beloved of such workers.³²

While the examples for winged figures can be found to illustrate influences available to Doble, there is nothing to explain the incongruity of fully extended wings on a creature at rest. The sculpture has the benefit of the dramatic impact of fully extended wings, but sacrifices complete unity of conception.

It is possible to detect a symbolist tone in the monument, a tone of high seriousness combined with an element of romanticism. The extended wings, the female figures, the sword as an object of dedication and chivalry, the evocation of symbolic concepts such as sacrifice, the turn of history, the honour of war are all elements to be found in Art Nouveau and symbolist works. It recalls the mood in Burne-Jones' The Sleeping Beauty from The Briar Rose Series 4 (1879–90) (Illus.56), and somewhat diluted, that of Voice of Evening by Gustave Moreau (Illus.57). The monumentality of the group invigorates the legacy of Burne-Jones and Moreau in Doble's work, but it does not eliminate the mood. The monument's present setting with a background of dark trees does nothing to detract from this, though the original setting was more open.

³² *Masterpieces, ibid.*, p.94.

CONCLUSION

Commemorative monuments are a sign for a significant event. In the case of the Wellington War Memorial, as for all other First World War memorials, it is a sign of loss and pride. The Wellington community had contributed a large number of men to the WWI Australian army, and were prepared to pay what was to them a large amount of money for an imposing monument to the dead soldiers. To this purpose their War Memorial Committee held a design competition which Doble won. While an art work must stand alone and on its own merits, the reason for its making must be found in its social setting. Account can be taken of the immediate community, the artist and his patron, and the wider culture of communities involved in the war.

Doble had an established reputation for making monuments. His clients would have been perhaps unschooled in the finer points of sculpture and architecture, and could have been impressed by size, finish and quality of materials, with cheapness as an added benefit.

The surprise is the distinct change in approach between not only his previous work and the Wellington monuments, but also the change he made to the accepted design. Previous works are unresolved, but in Wellington, Doble had refined his expression to achieve a degree of unity and refinement, as well as a multilayered meaning reflecting past and present myth.

In its use of female figures, direct classical references and Art Nouveau style, it is set apart in Australian war memorials. Related to the main body of Australian war memorials and those of other combatant countries in World War One, the use of female figures throughout the design is a significant pointer both to Doble's practice and to the temper of the Australian community.

Doble had consistently used classical imagery in his medal, trophy and plaque making. If, as can be suspected, he was a follower of the Art and Craft Movement, he could have been aware of the use of Classical as well as medieval references made by the Pre-Raphaelites, as well, classical references would have been understood, if only in a basic fashion, even by only moderately educated people.

While the group is a late expression of Art Nouveau, it is permeated with classical iconography. In the statue, the plinth and in the garden setting, the persistent use of references to European practice speak of more than coincidence or accidental success. They are surely a sign of a considered programme.

It is unclear how much of the whole conception originated with Doble or with his friend and patron Murdoch McLeod. However, Doble's past work, though unresolved, shows an extensive knowledge of such things as the significance of classical motifs, the use of monumentality, and of architectural settings. Even passing remarks from McLeod and photographs of other works could have been the trigger for the change evident in his monument in Wellington.

In its idiosyncratic choice of motif and style, the Wellington group is unusual in Australian practice after the war. Art Nouveau had virtually come to an end in Europe at the beginning of the war, with new, "modern", futuristic work pointing both to Surrealism in 1921 and to Art Deco in 1925 was appearing. There is a sense that Doble's sculpture could be called conservative in its adherence to the known and its crisp "realism", and in that it fits with his previous practice. At no point is there a hint that he admits the sculptural treatment of Rodin, or the new approaches of the Cubists.

Doble had adopted the Neo-Classical interpretation of the female body in his classical scenes, but for his sculptures, he had used a more buxom form related to Michelangelo. In a

sense, while Renaissance influences are evident, visual correspondences can be found with Norman Lindsay's paintings, placing the group firmly into the Australian scene.

While the group fulfils its purpose as an affecting sign, the figures lack the sexual tension which makes McKenna's Circe so striking. Doble would hardly be thanked for exceeding his brief so far, but the omission necessarily makes the expression in his group less powerful.

Remote though Doble may be from the mainstream of sculptural expression, his facility and technical ability combined with his conviction and vision surely earn him a place in the commentary on sculpture in Australia.

APPENDIX 1

THE MYTHS

The War Memorial at Wellington emerges as a sign for three or four myths, or ways of belief. In the process of expressing both grief and pride, the Memorial uses imagery based on those of the Classical world, overlaid by modern style. Because of the particular war, and the men who served in it, both for Australia and for world justice as they saw it, the War Memorial makes an image as a metaphor for ideals and ideas. In the sense that the brute facts of war have been idealized into a mental state that promotes the noble and heroic nature of sacrifice, the ethos of both the citizen soldier as a type and Anzac veneration could be called myths.

The memorial as it stands hardly represents Christian grief. For the families who lost men at the war, the memorial was to be a cenotaph, an empty grave. A devout community, Wellington perhaps felt the loss of a monument suitable for mourning the Christian dead. Without the statue, the plinth resembled a headstone. With the statue, it was placed in a different sphere.

In no sense could the realistic treatment of the sculpture so acceptable to many be said to be representing reality. There never was a "real", flesh and blood Victory, a muse of History, a war-like spirit. As metaphors for abstract concepts, they can be taken uncritically (in the metaphor, not the fact) by the observer—the problematic nature of "reality" and where it stands in one's consciousness is unexamined.

By contrast, an illustration by George Lambert of a shearers' horse race had been examined critically by countrymen unconcerned with "art" for the riders' seats and their tack.¹ Their dialogue with the image was not mediated by the creative—the image served as an icon. With the Wellington Memorial, perceptions and acceptance of the realistic, "unreal" image are for most observers unmediated. They "know" what it means; it is so real.

At the time of the First World War, knowledge of Classical references was assumed by all educated people.² The audience for literature and art was wide, and enjoyed extracting meaning from Classical metaphor. In the modern world, the Greek myth served as a metaphor for contemporary concerns. For the Ancient Greek, it was their world view.³

Servicemen even today tell of the primacy in their lives of the world of comradeship and common survival under fire. To some extent, the world of the armed forces is more real than that of civilian life. As recorded in Mosse and Leed⁴, the soldiers, particularly in the First World War, saw themselves as having been through an initiation to a different reality. Mosse explains the phenomenon of the romanticizing of the war experience as a characteristic of those who volunteered, who saw themselves as freely laying down their lives for a fine principle.

The tradition had its beginnings in the revolutionary army that raised itself to repulse the royalists in 1793⁵, and in the American Civil War in 1861–64⁶. The war of liberation in

¹ Own observation of viewers in Dubbo of the Lambert exhibition, 1993. Ann Gray (notes), *A Brush with the Bush: George Lambert – the Early Years*, Dubbo Regional Art Gallery, 1993, illustration 5.

² Paul Fussell, *The Great War and Modern Memory*, Oxford University Press, 1985. (*find ref*).

³ Jane Harrison, *Prolegomena to the Study of Greek Religion*, Merlin Press, London, 1962.

⁴ George Mosse, *Fallen Soldiers: Reshaping the Memory of the World Wars*, Oxford University Press, New York, 1990, p.25. Eric J. Leed, *No Man's Land: Combat and Identity in World War I*, Cambridge University Press, London, 1979, p.12.

⁵ Mosse, *op. cit.*, p.16.

⁶ American Civil War *find ref*.

Prussia in 1813⁷ and the Franco-Prussian War in 1871 again saw volunteers on the battlefield, and a consolidation of the new soldier idealism⁸. World War I and World War II continued the tradition. Here, perhaps, is the answer to the refusal of the Returned Services League to accept the Vietnam veterans into the ranks of returning heroes—they were not all volunteers. Some were National Servicemen, conscripts.

The Anzac myth, or legend, seems an extension, an elaboration of the citizen soldier tradition. There was a sense of a race proved and refined in the crucible of war.⁹¹⁰

An intimation of mission ran side by side with accolades to the men who helped save civilization, and proved Australia's worth through war.

Following the Second World War, sentiments of racial refinement lost favour, but the celebration of an heroic army, with its reflected glory shining on the nation, continues unabated.¹¹

Christian belief in our day is questioned and examined, and is no longer a requirement for respectability. But in the inter-war years in Australia, a strong and unquestioning Christian faith was held by a large proportion of the community. Sectarian questions were hotly debated, and even in the 1960's, the division between Catholics and Protestants was fiercely maintained. In a country town of Wellington's nature, questions of meaning, faith and imagery would have been discussed. There may have even been the feeling existing at that

⁷ Mosse, *op. cit.*, p.17.

⁸ Mosse, *loc. cit.*

⁹ K.S. Inglis, "Monuments in the Modern City" in Derek Fraser (ed.), *Cities, Class and Communication: Essays in Honour of Asa Briggs*, Harvester Wheatsheaf, Hemel Hempstead, 1990, p.94.

¹⁰ Insert J.S. McDonald, "Arthur Streeton", *Art in Australia*, October, 1931. "If we choose we can yet be the elect of the world, the last of the pastoralists, the thoroughbred Aryans in all their nobility." in Bernard Smith with Terry Smith, *Australian Painting 1788–1990*, Oxford University Press, Melbourne, 1991, p.167.

¹¹ (No separate reference visible on page; continues from preceding discussion.)

time in England that any image, even a cross, was idolatrous,¹² so the pagan image of the Victory would have been an anathema.

¹² K.S. Inglis, "The War Memorial Movement in Cambridge" in *Journal of Contemporary History*, Vol.27 No.4, October 1992, p.596.

APPENDIX 2

THE HISTORY

World War One is seen now as a catalogue of mistakes and misjudgments,¹ casting a long shadow on society to the present day.² So profound was the effect that commemoration thus far has hardly abated in commitment, though the tenor of ceremonies has changed slightly.³ A town like Wellington that saw off such a large proportion of their population to the war⁴ had a strong reason to have imposing images as memorials.

War had been in the air for some time before August, 1914. France was dedicated to recovering the territory of Alsace–Lorraine lost in the Franco-Prussian War of 1870, but was determined not to be seen as the aggressor. Similarly Germany was cautious about being labelled the aggressor,⁵ though they had supported with vigour the aggressive lack of negotiation of Austria with Serbia.⁶ The Germans saw themselves as the saviours of mankind, a "victory of soul"⁷ which was opposed to the pacifism of civilization. Thomas Mann equated peace to civil corruption.⁸

Apart from the irritation of the world with Germany's sabre-rattling, war was welcomed as a purifying force, the vehicle of the renewal of nations.⁹ They had counted neither on the Germans' adherence to their '*Kriegsbrauche*' which taught among other things

¹ Barbara Tuchman, *The March of Folly*, Ballantyne, New York, 1987. Tuchman, *August 1914*, Constable and Co., London, 1962.

² Paul Fussell, *The Great War and Modern Memory*, Oxford University Press, Oxford, 1975.

³ John Laffin, *Guide to Australian Battlefields of the Western Front 1916–1918*, Kangaroo Press, Sydney and A.W.M., Canberra, 1992, p.31. Also see list of newspaper cuttings.

⁴ C.I. McDonald, *They Came to a Valley – Wellington NSW 1817–1967*, Wellington Times Commercial Printing Department, 1968, p.172. Wellington *August 1914*, p.126.

⁵ Roger Parkinson, *The Origins of World War One*, Wayland (Publishers) Ltd., Hove, U.K., 1970, pp.99–100.

⁶ Tuchman, *August 1914*, p.126.

⁷ Thomas Mann, in Tuchman, *August 1914*, pp.303–304.

⁸ Tuchman, *loc. cit.*

⁹ Tuchman, *ibid.*, p.305.

warfare against civilian populations, nor the industrialization of war, most particularly the use of the machine gun.

Nations rushed to France's side, and to the defence of Belgium.¹⁰ The burning of the Library at Louvain, and the violent intimidation of the Belgian people turned the world against Germany.¹¹ There was a feeling of defending truth and justice against the forces of darkness.¹² The fervour of "honour" and "nobleness"¹³ drew citizen armies together, later to be augmented by conscription, but ready to sacrifice their lives for a great cause.¹⁴ Australia alone did not adopt conscription.¹⁵

The carnage and losses of World War One created almost universally in combatant countries an urge to raise memorials to all who died, not just to victorious generals or single heroes.¹⁶ With so many going to war, a large proportion were well educated, and the horror of the destruction of young lives invited the use of the metaphor of sacrifice of youths and maidens to the Minotaur in Greek legend. The thousands of miles of trenches even provided an image for the Labyrinth.¹⁷ Blood and sacrifice confirmed consecration, and many soldiers saw themselves as having gone through an initiation, taking them into a world the civilian could not share.¹⁸

England was drawn into the war greatly against the will of the Government because of the treaty they had with Belgium guaranteeing her neutrality.¹⁹ Australians felt strongly that

¹⁰ Tuchman, *ibid.*, p.129.

¹¹ Tuchman, *ibid.*, p.314.

¹² Tuchman, *ibid.*, p.130. Also see recruiting poster *Take up the Sword of Justice*, Australian War Memorial, Canberra.

¹³ Rupert Brooke in Tuchman, *op. cit.*, pp.303–304.

¹⁴ George Mosse, *Fallen Soldiers: Reshaping the Memory of the World Wars*, Oxford University Press, New York, 1990, p.17.

¹⁵ Michael McKernan, *The Australian People and the Great War*, Thomas Nelson Australia, Melbourne, 1980, p.7.

¹⁶ Mosse, *op. cit.*, p.45 (1870–71).

¹⁷ Modris Eksteins, *Rites of Spring: The Great War and the Birth of the Modern Age*, Bantam Press, London, 1989 (find ref).

¹⁸ Eric J. Leed, *No Man's Land: Combat and Identity in World War One*, Cambridge University Press, London, 1979 (find ref).

¹⁹ Tuchman, *August 1914*, pp.96–97.

their duty was to support the Mother Country against aggressors. With the sufferings of Belgium to spur them, men and women found it an honour to serve. Even such a supporter of Australian nationalism as Henry Lawson could see defending the Empire as a duty in time of war.²⁰

Duty was not the only spur. War as had been experienced in South Africa, the most recent for Australian soldiers, promised adventure and relief from boredom. Australians were secure in their belief in the vitality of their society,²¹ and so did not see the need for regeneration, but they did see it as a way to prove the mettle of the new nation in battle.²² The writings of C.E.W. Bean, the only Australian war correspondent at Gallipoli, recorded events for his later history of Australia's involvement in World War One. So struck was he by the horror, futility and waste of lives that he was urgent in his development of a suitable accolade to the fallen, what is now called the Anzac legend.²³ Later, so strong had the phenomenon become, especially after the Second World War and the Korean War, that great efforts were made by Vietnam veterans and their supporters for acceptance into the heroes' ranks.

There was a strong movement in Australia between the wars responding to Nietzsche's writings, particularly following the lead of Baylesbridge, an Australian writer and poet.²⁴ Part of these were allusions to Classical themes. Norman Lindsay, in particular, espoused devotion to creative forces epitomized in the god Pan in his book *Creative Effort—An Essay in Affirmation*.²⁵ Classical references would not be lost even on Australians from the Bush. People of even moderate education could know some ancient Greek myths, and could respond to those stories which seemed to bolster ideas of honour and sacrifice.

²⁰ Lyn Sutherland, *The Fantastic Invasion: Kipling, Conrad and Lawson*, Melbourne University Press, Melbourne, 1989, p.16.

²¹ McKernan, *op. cit.*, pp.130–131.

²² K.S. Inglis, "Monuments in the Modern City", in Derek Fraser (ed.), *Cities, Class and Communication: Essays in Honour of Asa Briggs*, Harvester Wheatsheaf, Hemel Hempstead, 1990, p.94.

²³ Noel McLachlan, *Waiting for the Revolution: A History of Australian Nationalism*, Penguin Books Australia Ltd., Victoria, 1989, pp.187ff.

²⁴ Noel Macainsh, *Nietzsche in Australia*, Verlag für Dokumentation und Werbung, Munich, 1975.

²⁵ Norman Lindsay, *Creative Effort: An Essay in Affirmation*, Cecil Palmer, London, 1924, 2nd Edition.

With Classical allusions available in vernacular imagery and writing, it is not surprising, perhaps, that Doble, and his patron Murdoch McLeod, gave Wellington with its great commitment to sacrifice for nation, a memorial with so many contained in it. That they were made in the Art Nouveau style placed them in their time, as the predilection for Classical themes in the Nietzschean mode placed theirs.

The strength of their necessity points to the power of the focus of the nation on Anzac Day. Well-established ritual is followed at each celebration on the 25th of April, with a form of 'service' provided by the Returned Services League of Australia, in such different circumstances as the big street Parade in Wagga Wagga, and the tiny parade in Yerong Creek with their minimal visible memorial. The Armed Forces take a prominent part in the parades and ceremony, which is run by the R.S.L.²⁶

Of all such events and attitudes, an object like the War Memorial in Wellington is an icon.

²⁶ Squadron Leader Colin Ford, "Anzac Day Address, 1993, Yerong Creek", Wagga Wagga. Attached form of Anzac Day Service, Returned Services League of Australia.

APPENDIX 3

ELECTRO-FORMING PROCESS

The electro-forming of metals consists of an electrolytic process where a cast coated with graphite is immersed in a metal salt bath which contains a plate of metal of the same type. For example, in forming copper, the salt in solution is copper sulphate, and the metal plate is copper. The graphite and the metal are then attached as the positive and negative poles, and an electric current passed through them. The metal forms at the rate of 1/32 inch in half an hour to one hour.¹

A 'female' plaster cast is made from the original, and is coated with the graphite. With an all-round figure, the cast is in one piece, and so is destroyed when being removed from the sculpture.² In the case of a flat plate, the cast is open and can be re-used.

The disadvantages of the process are that small, sharp corners have an inadequate amount of metal deposited and show weakness, and that the resulting copper is pure metal which is vulnerable to oxidation in the open air.³

¹ Arthur Murch, *Letter to George Lambert – 28-1-29*, see reproduction, page 126.

² Bruce Sutherland, 1993.

³ Victor Cusack, 1993.

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ILLUSTRATIONS

Gilbert Doble and his Work

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Wellington War Memorial, Wellington, NSW (1923–33)

Gilbert Doble.

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1. Self Portrait Gilbert Doble



2. The Discovery of Gold (1906)
Charles Richardson



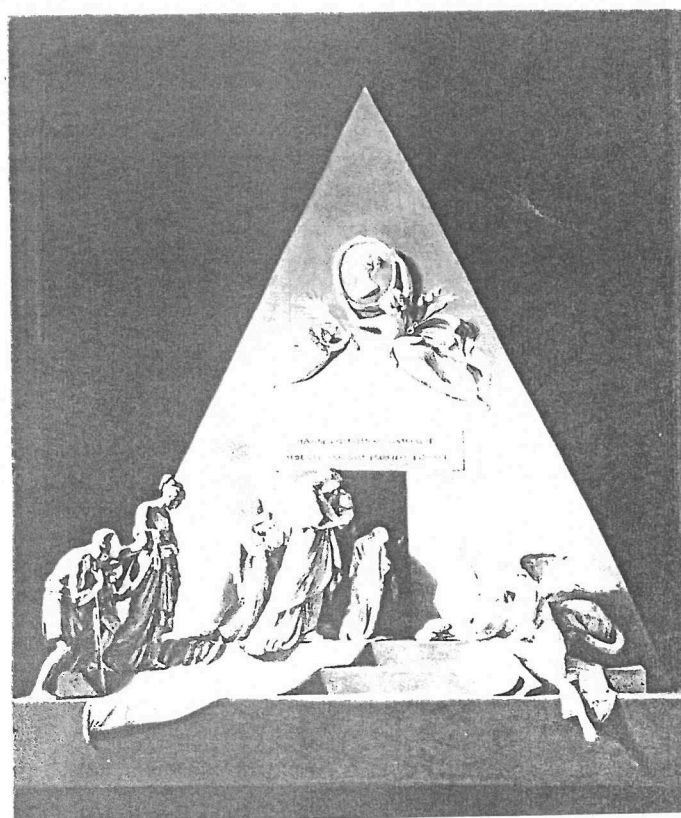
3. Pegasus (?1933) Gilbert Doble



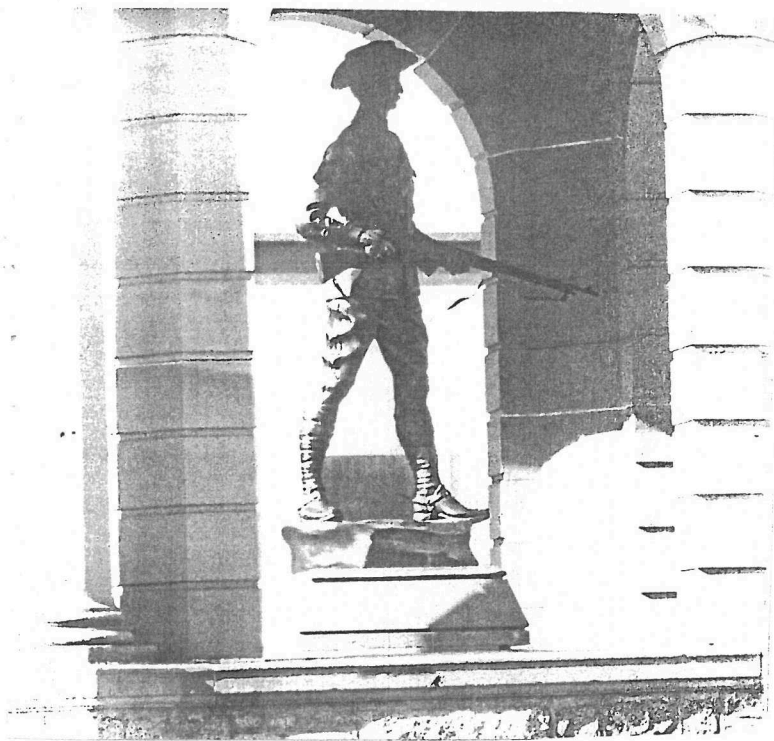
4. Tomb of the Archduchess Maria Christina (1798-1805)
Antonio Canova



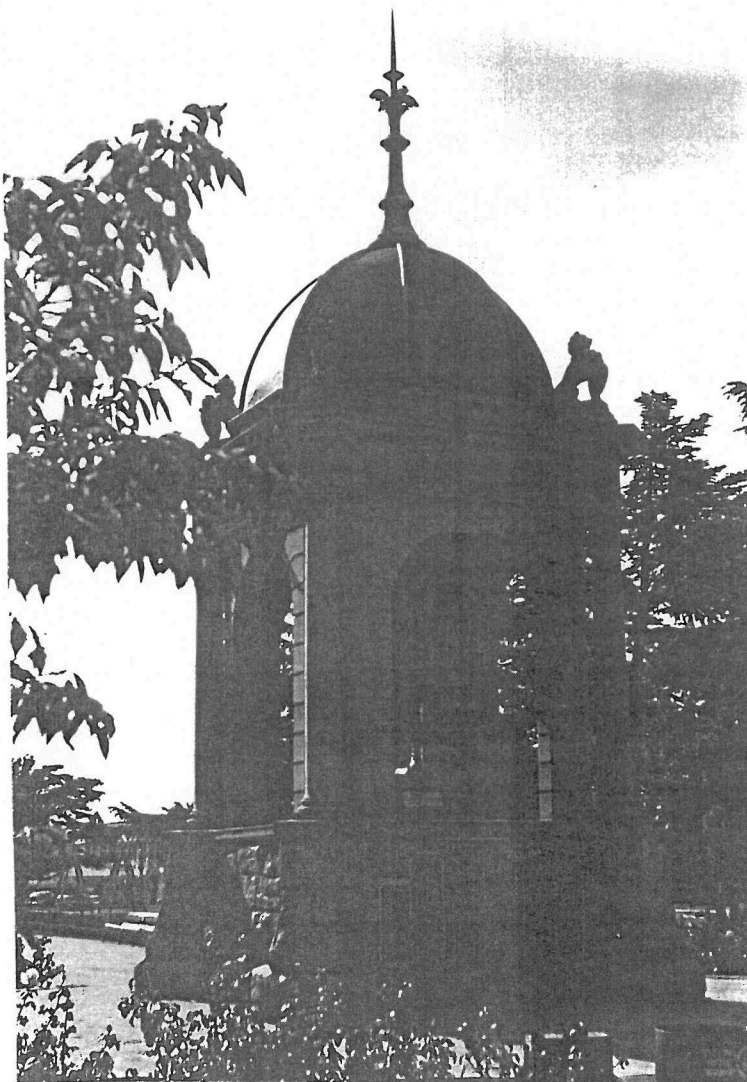
5. Pauline Borghese as Venus (1808)
Antonio Canova



6. Canova's Tomb of the Archduchess Maria Christina
(based on an engraving by Pietro Bonato, 1805)
Charles Swaggers, 1833



7. (i) Boer War Memorial, Bathurst, NSW (1910)
Gilbert Doble - Figure



(ii) Boer War Memorial, Bathurst, NSW (1910)
Cupola J.J. Copeman



8. Queen Victoria Memorial, Melbourne
(1903) James White



9. (i) Evans Memorial, Bathurst, NSW (1913-1918)
Gilbert Doble - detail



(ii) Evans Memorial, Bathurst, NSW (1913-1918)
Gilbert Doble - detail



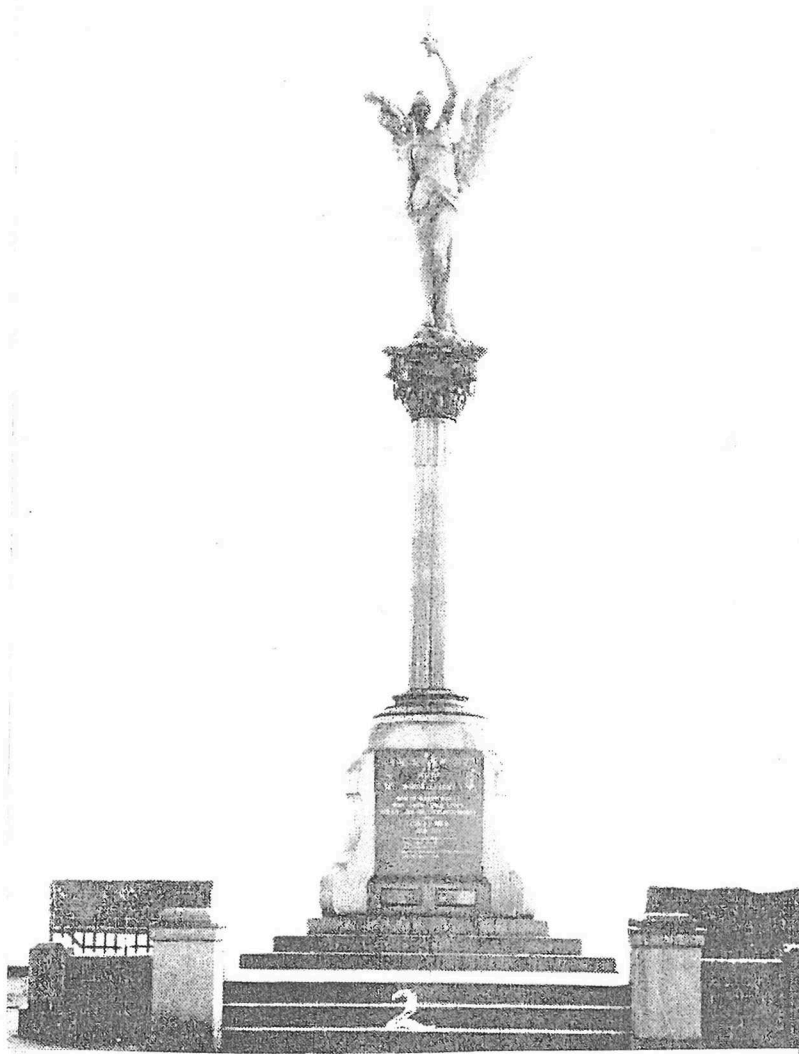
10. Figure of Explorer, Department of Lands
Building, Sydney



11. The Golden Stairs (1880) Sir Edward Burne-Jones



12. The Beguiling of Merlin (1874)
Sir Edward Burne-Jones



13. Marrickville War Memorial. Sydney, NSW
(1919) Gilbert Doble



14. Nike (archaic Greek) (bronze)
British Museum



16. Nike of Samothrace (c. 200-190 BC)
Louvre, Paris

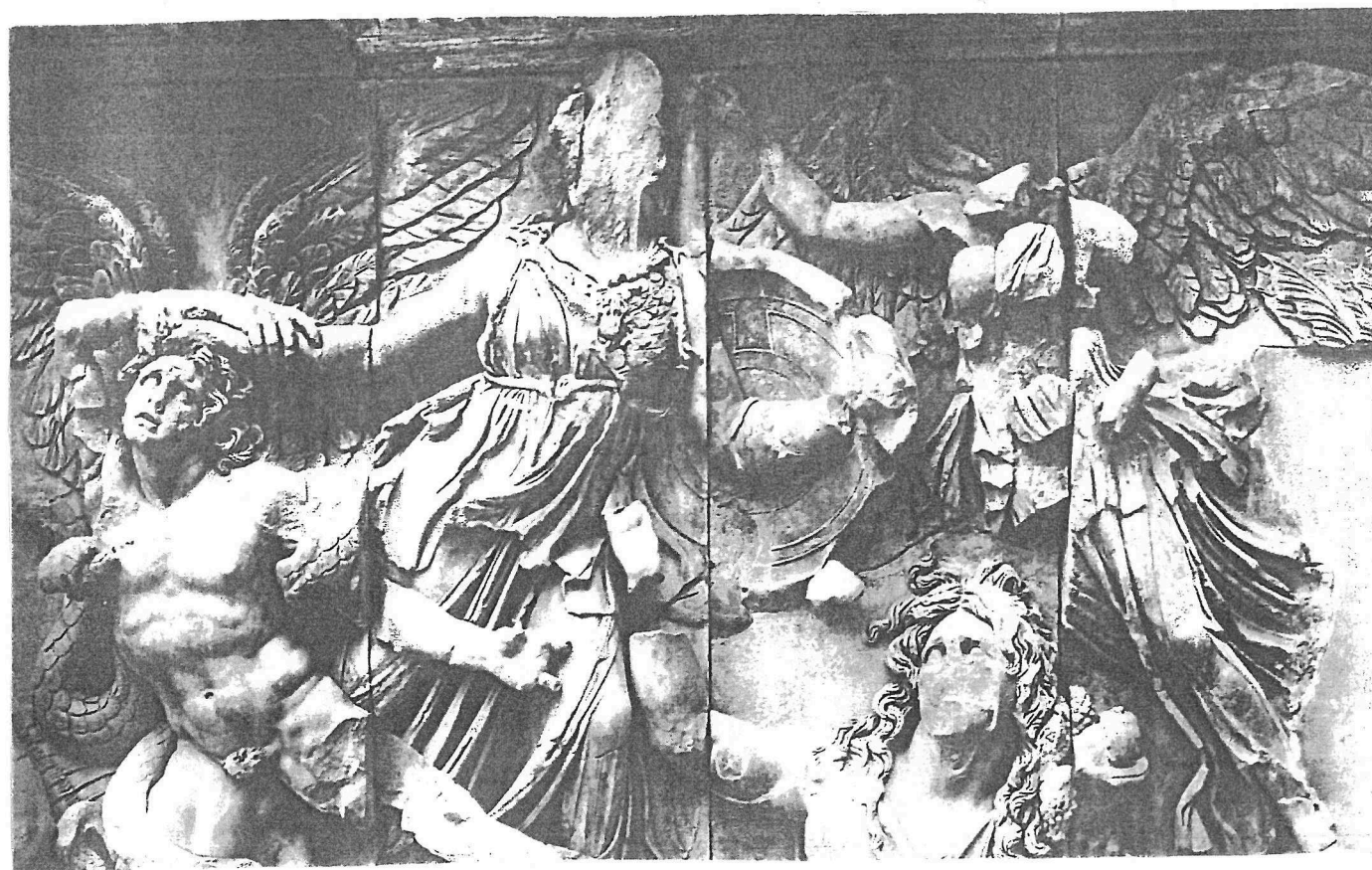


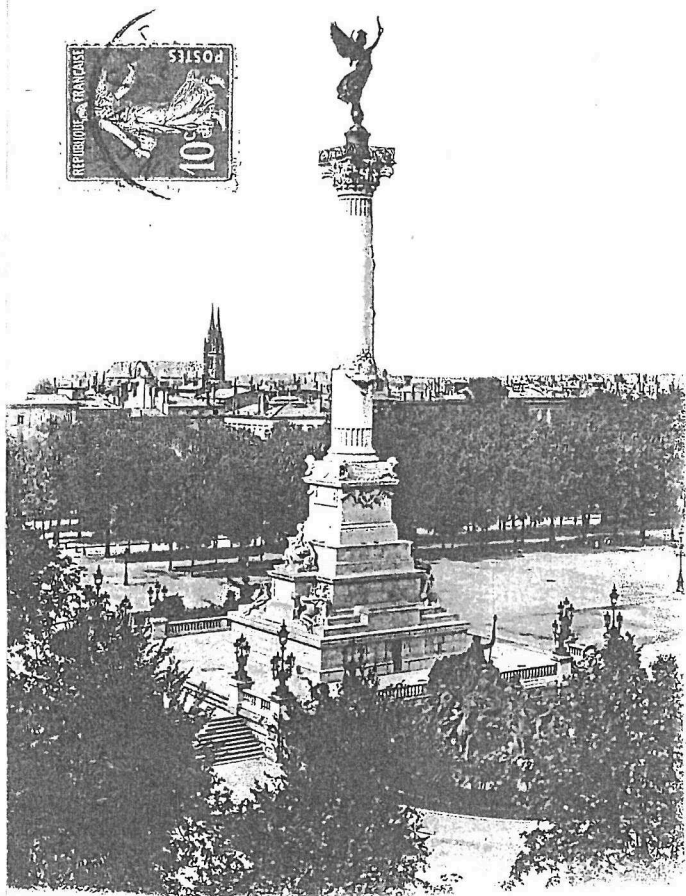
15. Nike Paionios, Olympia Museum



17. Nike adjusting her sandal
(c. 410-407 BC)

18. Athena and Alcynoneus, altar of Zeus (c. 180 BC)





19. Le Monument des Girondins Bordeaux



20. Eastbourne War Memorial, England (1920)
H.C. Fehr



21. Colchester Memorial, England (1920-21)
H.C. Fehr



22. Leeds Memorial, England (1922)
H.C. Fehr



23. Finsbury Memorial, England (?1919)



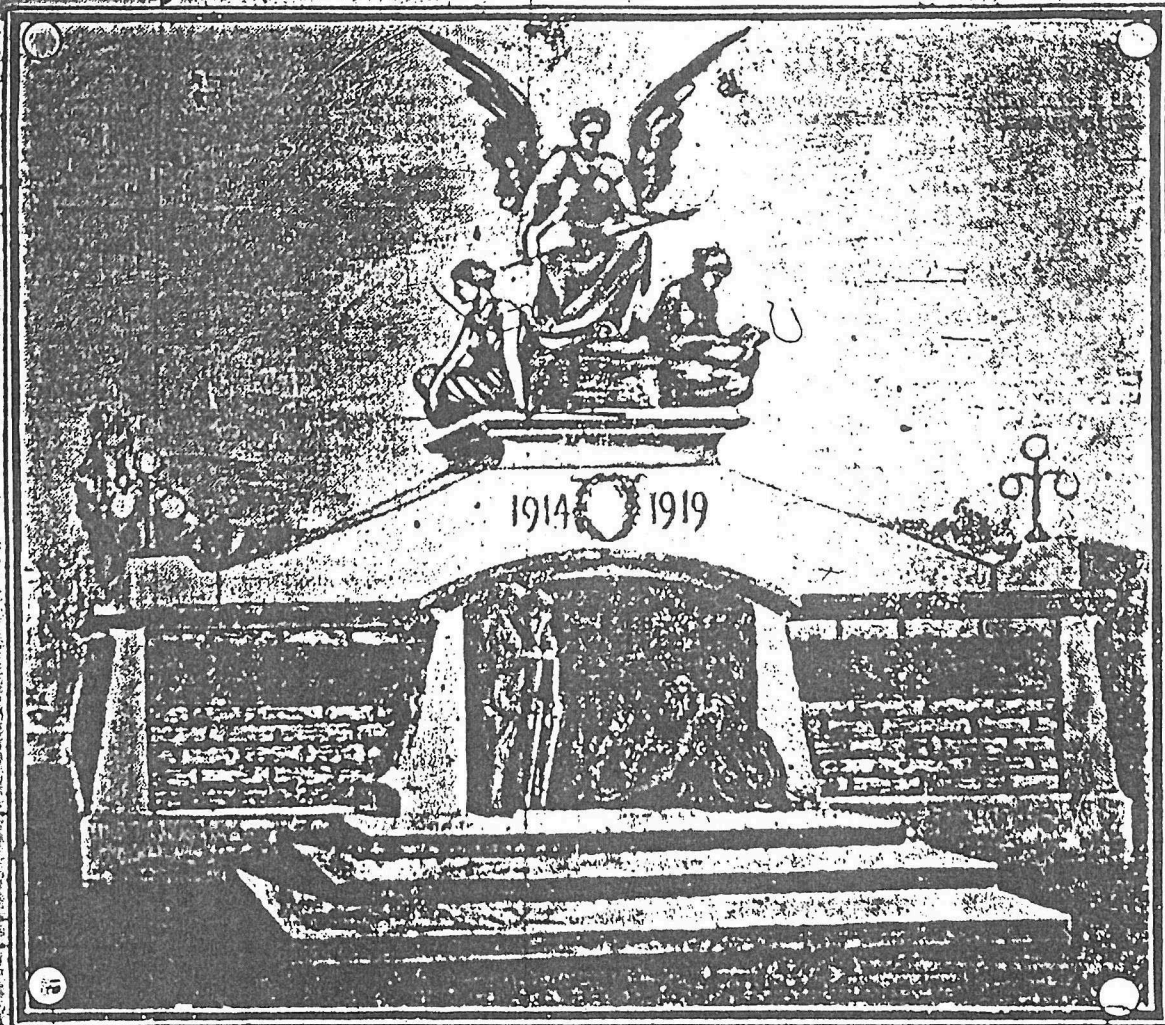
SKETCH MODEL. GILBERT DOBLE, SCULPTOR.

24. Pyrmont War Memorial, Sydney, NSW (1920)
Gilbert Doble - maquette

WELLINGTON SOLDIERS' MEMORIAL.

The Accepted Design.

This is the
accepted
design for the
Wellington
Soldiers'
Memorial
submitted by
Mr. Gilbert
Doble,
Marrickville.



If the design
is approved
by the
Board of
Architects
the designer
will be
awarded the
special prize
of £100
given by Mr.
M. McLeod.

25. Competition Design (1920) Gilbert Doble



26. (i) Leichhardt War Memorial, Sydney, NSW
(1922) Gilbert Doble



(ii) Leichhardt War Memorial, Sydney, NSW
(1922) Gilbert Doble



27. (i) Wellington War Memorial, Wellington, NSW
(1923-33) Gilbert Doble